“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 2

The Auspicious Invocation Indicating the Object: Determining the Truth of Caitanya

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In this second chapter the author reveals that Śrī Caitanya and Śrī Kṛṣṇa are one truth (*tattva*), and he proves that Brahman is the radiance of His body and the Paramātmā, the Supersoul, His part (*aṁśa*). He then proves that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the supreme shelter of the *puruṣa-avatāras* and of all living beings, and so establishes that Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa. He shows why one must know Kṛṣṇa’s intrinsic nature (*svarūpa*) and His three potencies. Kṛṣṇa’s *svarūpa* manifests in two ways, as *prābhava* and *vaibhava*; the avatāras are of two kinds, *aṁśa-avatāras* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*; and His original pastimes are of two kinds, marked by childhood (*bālya*) and boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*). Having shown this, the author establishes that Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form (*kiśora*) is Himself the source of all avatāras. He also shows that the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) manifests as Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes, the potency of māyā as countless universes, and the potency of living beings (*jīva-śakti*) as countless living beings. He establishes that Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the cause of all causes and the beginning of all; He Himself has no beginning; He is the eternal form of being, consciousness and bliss, Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. And he concludes that every devotee must know the truth of his relationship with the Lord (*sambandha-jñāna*), that is, must know Kṛṣṇa’s *svarūpa*, His three potencies and His *vilāsas*.

Obeisance to Gaura through examining the conclusions (siddhānta) of devotion —

শ্রীচৈতন্যপ্রভুং বন্দে বালোঽপি যদনুগ্রহাৎ ।
তরেন্নানামতগ্রাহব্যাপ্তং সিদ্ধান্তসাগরম্ ॥ ১ ॥

śrī-caitanya-prabhuṁ vande
Śrī Caitanya the Lord I worship
bālo 'pi yad-anugrahāt
a child even by whose mercy
taren nānā-mata-grāha-
may cross of various doctrines crocodiles
vyāptaṁ siddhānta-sāgaram
filled with of conclusions the ocean

1 I worship Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose mercy even an ignorant child can cross the ocean of philosophical conclusions, which teems with the crocodiles of various doctrines.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Śrī Caitanya Prabhu. By His mercy even an ignorant person easily crosses the ocean of conclusions (*siddhānta*), full of crocodiles and other beasts — the doctrines of every kind.

Anubhāṣya.

bālaḥ api (even one who is ignorant, a child) **yad-anugrahāt** (by whose mercy, that is, by whose compassion) **nānā-mata-grāha-vyāptam** (full of doctrines that are like crocodiles and sharks. These doctrines were proclaimed by Aulūkya, Jina, Buddha, Jaimini, Patañjali, Gotama, Kaṇāda, Kapila, Śaṅkara and Dattātreya; they quarrel with one another and are full of worldly self-interest) **siddhānta-sāgaram** (the ocean of reasoning) **taret** (crosses. That is, he counts the mixed doctrines of these worldly people as straw and comes to know Kṛṣṇa's pure feet) **śrī-caitanya-prabhum** ([that] Śrī Caitanya Prabhu) **vande** ([I] worship).

A prayer for Śrī Caitanya's mercy, for the sake of kīrtana about Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণোৎকীর্ত্তনগাননর্ত্তনকলাপাথোজনি-ভ্রাজিতা
সদ্ভক্তাবলিহংসচক্রমধুপশ্রেণীবিহারাস্পদম্ ।
কর্ণানন্দিকলধ্বনির্বহতু মে জিহ্বামরুপ্রাঙ্গণে
শ্রীচৈতন্যদয়ানিধে তব লসল্লীলাসুধাস্বর্ধুনী ॥ ২ ॥

kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-kalā-pāthojani-bhrājitā
of Kṛṣṇa loud glorification singing dancing arts lotuses adorned

sad-bhaktāvali-haṁsa-cakra-madhupa-śreṇī-vihārāspadam
of true devotees rows swans cakravāka birds bees swarms of pleasure abode

karṇānandi-kala-dhvanir vahatu me jihvā-maru-prāṅgaṇe
delighting the ears sweet sound may it flow my of the tongue desert over the expanse

śrī-caitanya dayā-nidhe tava lasal-līlā-sudhā-svardhunī
O Śrī Caitanya of mercy ocean Your shining pastimes nectar celestial Gaṅgā

2 O Śrī Caitanya, ocean of mercy! May the celestial Gaṅgā of the nectar of Your shining pastimes flow over the desert of my tongue. She is adorned with the lotuses of the loud glorification of Kṛṣṇa, of singing and of dancing; she is the place of delight for the rows of true devotees, who are like swans, cakravāka birds and bees; and her sweet murmur gladdens the ear.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Caitanyadeva, ocean of mercy! The nectar of Your pastimes is a shining Bhāgīrathī, the Gaṅgā. May it flow unceasingly through the field of my tongue, which is like a desert courtyard. Its lotuses are loud kīrtana about Kṛṣṇa, singing, dancing and the like; in it sport the saintly devotees — swans, *cakravāka* birds and bees; and its current makes a soft, sweet murmur that delights everyone's ears.

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-caitanya dayā-nidhe (O Śrī Caitanya, treasury of mercy) **kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-kalā-pāthojani-bhrājitā** (shining, that is, adorned, with lotuses [*pāthojani*]. These lotuses are the arts [*kalā*]: *utkīrtana*, the loud glorification of Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities, pastimes and so on, together with singing and dancing) **sad-bhaktāvali-haṁsa-cakra-madhupa-śreṇī-vihārāspadam** (the place of

play, the field of *vilāsa*, for the hosts of true, that is, pure devotees. They abide in various moods [*bhāvas*] and are like different flocks of swans, *cakravāka* birds and bees. The sense is that in these pastimes the hosts of pure devotees find the highest joy) **karṇānandi-kala-dhvaniḥ** (she whose gentle sound delights the ear and becomes an elixir for the devotees' ears. This gentle sound is the soft, sweet murmur of the streams of Hari's pastimes; the servants of Hari, who are like swans, *cakravākas* and bees, make it) **tava lasal-līlā-sudhā-svardhunī** (such is Your shining [*lasatī*, radiant] heavenly river [*svardhunī*], the Mandākinī, the heavenly Gaṅgā, full of the nectar of Gaura's pastimes) **me** (my) **jihvā-maru-prāṅgaṇe** (in the desert courtyard of the tongue. It has no taste, because it has been deprived of relishing the rasa of Gaura's pastimes) **vahatu** ([may she] flow).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ৩ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

3 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

Explanation of the third of the fourteen opening verses. Pointing out the Truth

—

তৃতীয় শ্লোকের অর্থ করি বিবরণ ।
বস্তু-নির্দ্দেশরূপ মঙ্গলাচরণ ॥ ৪ ॥

tṛtīya ślokera artha kari vivaraṇa
of the third verse the meaning I make explanation
vastu-nirdeśa-rūpa maṅgalācaraṇa
the Object indicating in the form of auspicious invocation

4 Now I shall explain in detail the meaning of the third verse. It is an auspicious invocation that points to the Supreme Truth (*vastu-nirdeśa*).[1]

যদদ্বৈতং ব্রহ্মোপনিষদি তদপ্যস্য তনুভা
য আত্মান্তর্যামী পুরুষ ইতি সোঽস্যাংশবিভবঃ ৷
ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যৈঃ পূর্ণো য ইহ ভগবান্ স স্বয়ময়ং
ন চৈতন্যাৎ কৃষ্ণাজ্জগতি পরতত্ত্বং পরমিহ ॥ ৫ ॥

yad advaitaṁ brahmopaniṣadi tad apy asya tanu-bhā
which non-dual Brahman in the Upaniṣads that also His bodily effulgence

ya ātmāntar-yāmī puruṣa iti so 'syāṁśa-vibhavaḥ
who the Supersoul the Indweller the Puruṣa thus He His portion manifestation

ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ pūrṇo ya iha bhagavān sa svayam ayaṁ
with six opulences full who here Bhagavān He Himself this one

na caitanyāt kṛṣṇāj jagati para-tattvaṁ param iha
not than Caitanya Kṛṣṇa in the world supreme truth higher here

5 "There is no Truth in the world higher than Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. That which the Upaniṣads call the non-dual Brahman is the effulgence of His body; the Puruṣa, the Supersoul who dwells within every heart, is His partial manifestation; and Bhagavān, full in all six opulences, is He Himself."[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The One whom the Upaniṣads call the nondual Brahman is the radiance of my Lord's body. The One whom the scriptures of yoga call the Puruṣa who dwells within (*antaryāmī*), or Paramātmā, is a part (*aṁśa*) of my Lord. The One who is the shelter of Brahman and Paramātmā, the whole (*aṁśī*) of which they are parts, is called Bhagavān, full in the six opulences. My Lord is that Bhagavān Himself. Therefore in the world there is no Supreme Truth higher than Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

upaniṣadi (in the Upaniṣad, that is, in a special branch of the Vedas, the highest of all, called *brahma-vidyā* [the knowledge of Brahman]. [The word *upaniṣad* is formed from the root *ṣad* with the prefixes *upa-* and *ni-* and the suffix *kvip*; the root means "to destroy," "to go" and "to wear down." Here *upa* means "having approached," that is, having received it through the guru's instruction, and *ni* means "with resolve." Some have approached *brahma-vidyā*, have resolutely fixed themselves in it and have lost their thirst for objects, both those that are seen and those

promised in the Vedas. For them it destroys the seed of worldly existence — loosens it, wears it down, annihilates it — and leads them to Brahman.]) **yat advaitam** (that which [is called] nondual, without a second), **brahma** (Brahman), **tat api** (that too) **asya** (His [Gaura-Kṛṣṇa's]) **tanu-bhā** (is the radiance [of His transcendental body]) **yaḥ ātmā** (He who is the Self [the Paramātmā, the Controller of all living beings and the rest]), **antar-yāmī puruṣaḥ** (the Puruṣa who dwells within), **saḥ asya aṁśa-vibhavaḥ** (is His partial manifestation [one of His opulences, a particular expression of His all-pervasiveness]) **iha** ([in this examination of the truth]) **yaḥ ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ** (He who in the six opulences, that is, in the six kinds of lordship — complete wealth, strength, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation —) **pūrṇaḥ** (is full [needs nothing, is perfect]), **saḥ ayam** (He, this Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya), **svayam bhagavān** (is Bhagavān Himself) **iha** ([in the world, in the examination of the truth, or in the Kali age]) **caitanyāt kṛṣṇāt** (than Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **param** (other) **para-tattvam** (supreme truth [better shelter]) **na** (there is none).

(Brahman is the goal of the scriptures of knowledge (*jñāna-śāstras*), and Paramātmā the goal of the scriptures of yoga. In truth they are equal to Bhagavān. But the view differs with the qualification (*adhikāra*) of the one who sees, and so they are only two aspects of Bhagavān's form — His spiritual radiance and His part. They are not the whole, complete Reality, endowed with all qualities and potencies; only Bhagavān is that.)

With this verse one should compare the following verse from Śrī Jīva Prabhu's *Tattva-sandarbha* (8): "His being, purely spiritual, receives the name Brahman in some places of the Vedas. His part is the Puruṣa, who subdues māyā and through His own parts displays variety. His one form sports in the spiritual sky (*paravyoma*) under the name Nārāyaṇa. May that Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān Himself, grant love of God (*prema*) here to those who take shelter of His feet."

Some are deprived of beholding the being and bliss (*sat* and *ānanda*) of Bhagavān, who is full of *sat*, *cit* and *ānanda*. They rely only on the function of consciousness (*saṁvit*) and, pursuing the Truth endowed with spiritual pastimes, in the end see Brahman. Others are deprived of beholding Bhagavān's bliss (*ānanda*). They rely only on the functions of being and consciousness (*sat* and *cit*) and, pursuing the same Truth, in the end see Paramātmā. Thus Bhagavān is the form of being, consciousness and bliss and of divine pastimes. The spiritual radiance of His body is

Brahman, devoid of spiritual *vilāsa* and free from māyā,[12] and the being that is a portion of His majesty (*aiśvarya*) is Paramātmā.

Examining the Truth —

ব্রহ্ম, আত্মা, ভগবান্ — অনুবাদ তিন ।
অঙ্গপ্রভা, অংশ, স্বরূপ — তিন বিধেয় চিহ্ন ॥ ৬ ॥

brahma, ātmā, bhagavān — anuvāda tina
Brahman, Paramātmā, Bhagavān — subjects three
aṅga-prabhā, aṁśa, svarūpa — tina vidheya cihna
of the body effulgence, portion, own form — three predicates marks

6 Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are the three *anuvādas* (that which is spoken of); the effulgence of the body, the partial manifestation and His own form are the three *vidheyas* (that which is stated about them).

অনুবাদ আগে, পাছে বিধেয় স্থাপন ।
সেই অর্থ কহি, শুন শাস্ত্রবিবরণ ॥ ৭ ॥

anuvāda āge, pāche vidheya sthāpana
the subject first, afterwards the predicate placing
sei artha kahi, śuna śāstra-vivaraṇa
that meaning I tell, hear of scripture the explanation

7 First the *anuvāda* is stated, and afterwards the *vidheya* is set down. In this way I shall tell the meaning of the verse; hear now the explanation according to scripture.

Kṛṣṇa, and the truth about Caitanya —

স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ, বিষ্ণু-পরতত্ত্ব ।
পূর্ণজ্ঞান পূর্ণানন্দ পরম মহত্ত্ব ॥ ৮ ॥

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa, viṣṇu-paratattva
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa, of Viṣṇu the supreme truth
pūrṇa-jñāna pūrṇānanda parama mahattva
full knowledge full bliss supreme greatness

8 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the supreme truth among all forms of Viṣṇu (*viṣṇu-tattva*). He is fullness of knowledge, fullness of bliss and the highest greatness.

'নন্দসুত' বলি' যাঁরে ভাগবতে গাই ।
সেই কৃষ্ণ অবতীর্ণ চৈতন্য-গোসাঞি ॥ ৯ ॥

'nanda-suta' bali' yāṁre bhāgavate gāi
'Nanda's son' calling whom in the Bhāgavata they sing
sei kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa caitanya-gosāñi
that Kṛṣṇa has descended (as) Caitanya the Lord

9 He whom the *Bhāgavatam* glorifies as the son of Nanda — that same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
According to the science of poetics (*alaṅkāra-śāstra*), one first states what is already known (the *anuvāda*) and only then indicates what is said about it (the *vidheya*). In many places the Vedas and other scriptures speak of three subjects — Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān. These truths are therefore already known, and they must be taken as the *anuvāda*. But it is not yet known that Brahman is the radiance of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's body, Paramātmā His part and Bhagavān His *svarūpa*. So one must first state these three *anuvādas* and then, after examining the meaning of the scriptures, establish the *vidheya*. The conclusion of the scriptures is this: among the *viṣṇu-tattvas* the Supreme Truth is Bhagavān Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. He whom the *Bhāgavatam* sings of as the son of Nanda has descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Therefore, when I discuss the truth, I shall speak of Kṛṣṇa and Caitanya as entirely non-different. And so the Supreme Truth appears in three ways — as Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān Himself — and I may rightly call all three special manifestations of Śrī Caitanya.

প্রকাশবিশেষে তেঁহ ধরে তিন নাম ।
ব্রহ্ম, পরমাত্মা আর স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ॥ ১০ ॥

prakāśa-viśeṣe teṁha dhare tina nāma
in particular manifestations He bears three names
brahma, paramātmā āra svayaṁ bhagavān
Brahman, Paramātmā and Himself Bhagavān

10 In His particular manifestations He bears three names: Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Prabhu Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (3): "Thus, when [the Truth] displays all Its distinguishing features, It is Bhagavān: He is Its full appearance and therefore the form of the undivided Truth. Brahman, however, is an incomplete appearance of that same Truth, for in Brahman the form with distinguishing features is not manifest. 'O sage! The sound *bha* carries two meanings, *sambhartā* and *bhartā*; the meanings of the sound *ga* are *netā*, *gamayitā* and *sraṣṭā*. Beings dwell in Him, the Self of beings, the Self of all, and He, the Imperishable, abides in all beings without exception — this is the meaning of the sound *va*. Knowledge, potency, strength, lordship, power and splendour in their fullness, without inferior qualities and the like — this is what the word Bhagavān denotes.' *Sambhartā* is He who nourishes His devotees; *bhartā*, He who sustains and establishes; *netā*, He who leads to the fruit of devotion to Him, that is, to prema; *gamayitā*, He who brings to His own abode; *sraṣṭā*, He who gives rise to various qualities in His devotees. (4) He Himself is not a cause: He is wholly absorbed in the *vilāsa* of His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) alone and is therefore indifferent to the world. Yet through the Puruṣa, His part, also called the Paramātmā, who sets *prakṛti* and the jīvas in motion, He becomes the cause of the world's creation, maintenance and so on. Know this as the form of Bhagavān. <…> As the efficient cause, He makes the jīvas, particles of Himself, enter bodies and the rest and so brings them to life. Impelled by Him, all the elements — *pradhāna* and the others, indicated by bodies and so on — move, that is, set about their work. Know this as the form of the Paramātmā. The jīva is an *ātmā*, a self, and compared with him He is the supreme (*parama*); therefore the word Paramātmā denotes just Him, the jīva's companion. That same Truth is present as the accompanying presence (*an-*

vaya) in dream and the other states; outside them It likewise abides in the pure potency called the jīva; and the particle *ca* ('and') shows that It also abides beyond them, separately (*vyatireka*), remaining by Itself. Know this as the form of Brahman."

Bhagavān is endowed with all potencies and reveals Himself in all His fullness; therefore He is the undivided Truth. In Brahman such a form with distinguishing features is not manifest; therefore Brahman is only a partial, incomplete appearance of Bhagavān. O sage! The first sound of the word Bhagavān, *bha*, has two meanings, *sambhartā* and *bhartā*; the sound *ga* means *netā*, *gamayitā* and *sraṣṭā*. Beings dwell in the universal Self, the Self of beings, and He, the imperishable Puruṣa, dwells in all beings without exception — this is the meaning of the sound *va*. Boundless knowledge, potency, strength, lordship, power and splendour, without inferior qualities — this is what the word Bhagavān denotes. *Sambhartā* means "He who nourishes His devotees"; *bhartā*, "He who sustains and establishes"; *netā*, "He who leads to the fruit of devotion to Him, that is, to *prema*"; *gamayitā*, "He who brings to His own abode"; *sraṣṭā*, "He who gives rise to various qualities in His devotees." There is a Truth that is not Itself a cause: through Its own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) It has a single *vilāsa* and is entirely indifferent to the world. And yet, through the Puruṣa, Its part, who sets *prakṛti* and the jīvas in motion, It becomes the cause of the world's birth, maintenance and so on. Know this as the truth of Bhagavān (*bhagavat-tattva*). There is One who, as the efficient cause, makes the jīvas, particles of Himself, enter the world and so brings the world to life. Impelled by Him, the elements — *pradhāna* and the others, indicated by bodies and so on — remain in place and each sets about its own work. Know Him as the Paramātmā. By his intrinsic nature the jīva is an *ātmā*, and the One higher than the jīva is *parama*; therefore the word Paramātmā reveals Him as the jīva's eternal companion. There is a Truth that is present as the accompanying presence (*anvaya*) in waking, dreaming and deep sleep. In *samādhi* It abides [as] the pure *jīva-śakti*, yet afterwards It also abides beyond it, separately (*vyatireka*), remaining by Itself. Know It as Brahman.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.11)

বদন্তি তত্তত্ত্ববিদস্তত্ত্বং যজ্‌জ্ঞানমদ্বয়ম্ ।
ব্রহ্মেতি পরমাত্মেতি ভগবানিতি শব্দ্যতে ॥ ১১ ॥

vadanti tat tattva-vidas
they call that of truth the knowers
tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
the Truth which knowledge non-dual
brahmeti paramātmeti
Brahman thus Paramātmā thus
bhagavān iti śabdyate
Bhagavān thus is named

11 "The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those who know the truth call nondual knowledge the Truth. This nondual knowledge is first perceived as Brahman, then as Paramātmā, and thirdly as Bhagavān.

Anubhāṣya.

The sages headed by Śaunaka asked Sūta, the disciple of Śukadeva, six questions. This verse answers the second of them: "What is the essence of the scriptures?"

tattva-vidaḥ ([those who know the truth) **tat** ([just] that) **tattvam** (the Truth), **advayam jñānam** (nondual knowledge [one, purely spiritual]), **vadanti** (they call) **yat** ([This nondual knowledge]) **brahma iti** ([in some places] Brahman), **paramātmā iti** ([in some places] Paramātmā), **bhagavān iti ca** ([and in some places] Bhagavān) **śabdyate** (is called).

The sense is this: nondual knowledge realised through the function of knowledge alone is Brahman; nondual knowledge realised through the functions of being and consciousness (*sat* and *cit*) is Paramātmā; and that same nondual knowledge realised through the functions of being, consciousness and bliss (*sat*, *cit* and *ānanda*) is Bhagavān.

Bhagavān's devotees know that the embodiment of nondual knowledge is Vrajendranandana, the son of the king of Vraja. In Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities and pastimes they see nothing second. If one separates Kṛṣṇa from His transcendental name, form, qualities and pastimes, a mundane conception of Viṣṇu's body arises; this is the very absence of nondual knowledge. Things other than Kṛṣṇa are not Viṣṇu, and nondual knowledge is not in them. Therefore everything other than Kṛṣṇa is separated from Kṛṣṇa, that is, from nondual knowledge, by māyā, or dual knowledge.[13] So it becomes liable to fall under māyā's control, and is therefore

subject to māyā, or dual knowledge. In all of Kṛṣṇa's manifestations (*prakāśas*) and forms of *vilāsa*, however, there is no knowledge of anything second; therefore they are *viṣṇu-tattva* and the masters of māyā. The yogīs regard only one state as free from knowledge of a second: the unmixed union (*yoga*) of the pure soul with the Paramātmā, the embodiment of nondual knowledge. The *jñānīs*, for their part, regard as nondual knowledge, as Brahman, a featureless knowledge free from all distinctions — internal, homogeneous and heterogeneous (*svagata*, *sajātīya* and *vijātīya*). See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Bhāgavatam* by the author of this commentary, pp. 88–89.

(1) Examining Brahman —

তাঁহার অঙ্গের শুদ্ধ কিরণ-মণ্ডল ।
উপনিষদ্ কহে তাঁরে ব্রহ্ম সুনির্ম্মল ॥ ১২ ॥

tāṁhāra aṅgera śuddha kiraṇa-maṇḍala
His of the body pure of rays the orb
upaniṣad kahe tāṁre brahma sunirmala
the Upaniṣads call that Brahman most pure

12 That which the Upaniṣads call the spotless Brahman is the pure radiance of the rays of His body.

Anubhāṣya.
Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad, second *muṇḍaka*, second *khaṇḍa*, mantras 9–11: "In the highest, golden sheath dwells Brahman, stainless and undivided. It is pure, the light of lights; those who know the Self know It. There the sun does not shine, nor the moon and stars, nor do these lightnings shine — how then this fire? As He shines, everything shines after Him; by His light all this is illumined. Truly, Brahman is this immortal one: Brahman in front, Brahman behind, Brahman to the right and to the left, below and above — spread everywhere. Truly, Brahman is all this, this most excellent universe."

চর্ম্মচক্ষে দেখে যৈছে সূর্য্য নির্ব্বিশেষ ।
জ্ঞানমার্গে লইতে নারে তাঁহার বিশেষ ॥ ১৩ ॥

carma-cakṣe dekhe yaiche sūrya nirviśeṣa
with fleshly eyes one sees as the sun without features
jñāna-mārge laite nāre tāṁhāra viśeṣa
on the path of knowledge to perceive cannot His particular features

13 As the sun appears to fleshly eyes as mere brilliance without features, so on the path of knowledge one cannot perceive His particular features.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nirviśeṣa. A *viśeṣa* is a feature by which a thing is recognised; what lacks such features is *nirviśeṣa*, featureless.

(Brahma-saṁhitā 5.40)

যস্য প্রভা প্রভবতো জগদণ্ডকোটি-
কোটিষ্বশেষবসুধাদিবিভূতিভিন্নম্ ।
তদ্ব্রহ্মনিষ্কলমনন্তমশেষভূতং
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ১৪ ॥

yasya prabhā prabhavato jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-
whose effulgence of the all-mighty of universes of millions
koṭiṣv aśeṣa-vasudhādi-vibhūti-bhinnam
in millions unlimited earths and the like opulences distinct from
tad brahma niṣkalam anantam aśeṣa-bhūtaṁ
that Brahman undivided infinite all-complete
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

14 "I worship Govinda, the original Person. Brahman — undivided, infinite and complete, distinct from all the opulences of countless universes, their earths and all else — is the effulgence of Him, the Almighty." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Govinda, the original Puruṣa. From His radiance comes Brahman — undivided, infinite, boundless, and distinct from the countless opulences of millions and millions of universes, such as their lands.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Brahmā set forth the truth and greatness of Śrī Govinda in the form of a prayer; it is given in the fifth chapter of the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.

jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-koṭiṣu (in millions and millions of universes, that is, in countless universes) **aśeṣa-vasudhādi-vibhūti-bhinnam** (distinct, that is, set apart, by the opulences — the countless universes and all else that has form and so on) **niṣkalam** ([that which is] without parts: undivided, perfect), **anantam** (beyond limited knowledge), **aśeṣa-bhūtam** (boundless —) **tat brahma** (that Brahman) **prabhavataḥ** ([of the One endowed with power]) **yasya** (whose [Govinda's]) **prabhā** (is the radiance of the body) **tam ādi-puruṣam govindam aham bhajāmi** (that original Puruṣa, Govinda, I worship).

কোটী কোটী ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে যে ব্রহ্মের বিভূতি ।
সেই ব্রহ্ম গোবিন্দের হয় অঙ্গকান্তি ॥ ১৫ ॥

koṭī koṭī brahmāṇḍe ye brahmera vibhūti
millions upon millions in the universes which of Brahman the glory
sei brahma govindera haya aṅga-kānti
that Brahman of Govinda is of the body the radiance

15 That Brahman whose glory is spread through millions upon millions of universes is the radiance of Govinda's body.

সেই গোবিন্দ ভজি আমি, তেঁহো মোর পতি ।
তাঁহার প্রসাদে মোর হয় সৃষ্টিশক্তি ॥ ১৬ ॥

sei govinda bhaji āmi, teṁho mora pati
that Govinda I worship I, He my Lord
tāṁhāra prasāde mora haya sṛṣṭi-śakti
His by the grace to me is of creation the power

16 I worship that Govinda; He is my Lord. By His grace I (Brahmā) have the power to create.

Anubhāṣya.

"I" is Brahmā.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.6.47)

মুনয়ো বাতবসনাঃ শ্রমণা ঊর্দ্ধমন্থিনঃ ।
ব্রহ্মাখ্যং ধাম তে যান্তি শান্তাঃ সন্ন্যাসিনোঽমলাঃ ॥ ১৭ ॥

munayo vāta-vasanāḥ
the sages the wind as clothing
śramaṇā ūrdhva-manthinaḥ
ascetics upward (who keep their seed)
brahmākhyaṁ dhāma te yānti
called Brahman the abode they go to
śāntāḥ sannyāsino 'malāḥ
peaceful renunciants pure

17 "Sages clothed by the wind, ascetics who keep their seed drawn upward, peaceful, pure renunciants — they go to the abode called Brahman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.6.47)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Naked sages who practice austerity and keep their seed, and peaceful, pure sannyāsīs, attain the abode of Brahman.

Anubhāṣya.
Uddhava learned that Śrī Kṛṣṇa would soon withdraw from view, and in a prayer at His holy feet he said: devotees reach Kṛṣṇa's feet with ease, while sannyāsīs who impose hardships on themselves win the fruit of their practice by hard labour — and attain only Brahmaloka.

vāta-vasanāḥ (clothed in the wind, that is, naked, without garments) **śramaṇāḥ** (mendicant monks who emaciate the body) **ūrdhva-manthinaḥ** (who keep their seed) **śāntāḥ** (those whose minds are fixed on Brahman alone) **amalāḥ** (free from the filth of sense objects) **sannyāsinaḥ** (*sannyāsīs*) **te** (they) **brahmākhyam** (called Brahman [impersonal]) **dhāma** (the abode) **yānti** (attain).

(2) Examining Paramātmā —

আত্মান্তর্য্যামী যাঁরে যোগশাস্ত্রে কয় ।
সেহ গোবিন্দের অংশ বিভূতি যে হয় ॥ ১৮ ॥

ātmāntaryāmī yāṁre yoga-śāstre kaya
the Supersoul the Indweller whom in the yoga scriptures they speak of
seha govindera aṁśa vibhūti ye haya
He of Govinda portion manifestation indeed is

18 The Supersoul, the Indweller, of whom the scriptures of yoga speak, is a partial manifestation of Govinda.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān is a form full of spiritual *vilāsa*. He is the *turīya-vigraha*, the form beyond the three states, and so He Himself has no part in any affairs of Devī-dhāma, the material world: He controls *pradhāna* and the jīvas through the *puruṣa-avatāras*. As soon as the jīva understands the truth of the three *puruṣa-avatāras*, he is freed from perceiving the twenty-four elements of māyā. Kṣīrodakaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu is the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) of each jīva; Garbhodakaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu is the indwelling Lord of the aggregate jīva of the universe; and the creator of the universes, Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu, is also an indwelling Lord. These three *puruṣa-avatāras* carry out the creation of Devī-dhāma and govern this partial work. The scriptures of yoga prescribe union (*yoga*) with Paramātmā in order to pass beyond the twenty-four elements of māyā. Thus the indwelling Puruṣa, Paramātmā, is only a partial manifestation (*aṁśa-vibhūti*) of Govinda.

অনন্ত স্ফটিকে যৈছে এক সূর্য্য ভাসে ।
তৈছে জীবে গোবিন্দের অংশ প্রকাশে ॥ ১৯ ॥

ananta sphaṭike yaiche eka sūrya bhāse
in countless crystals as one sun is reflected
taiche jīve govindera aṁśa prakāśe
so in living beings of Govinda the portion is manifest

19 As one sun is reflected in countless crystals, so Govinda's portion, the Supersoul, is manifest in every living being.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A single sun, reflected in countless pieces of crystal, shows itself in each as a separate image. So too Paramātmā, a part of Govinda, manifests in countless jīvas.

Anubhāṣya.

The one sun stays in its place and is reflected in countless pieces of crystal as countless images. So too the one Śrī Govinda, eternally manifest in Goloka-Vṛndāvana, manifests in the hearts of countless jīvas as the indwelling Paramātmā, the Puruṣa whom the jīva is meant to serve. The three mantras that begin "Two birds, inseparable friends…"[14] speak of two birds on one tree, the *jīvātmā* and Paramātmā; they stand in the relation of the servant and the One served. Paramātmā makes the *jīvātmā* taste the fruits of karma, but He Himself does not taste such fruits. When the jīva stops enjoying the fruits of karma and comes to know the glory of Paramātmā, whom he is meant to serve, he becomes stainless and attains the supreme equality — Vaikuṇṭha.

(Bhagavad-gītā 10.42)

অথবা বহুনৈতেন কিং জ্ঞাতেন তবার্জ্জুন ।
বিষ্টভ্যাহমিদং কৃৎস্নমেকাংশেন স্থিতো জগৎ ॥ ২০ ॥

atha vā bahunaitena
but or with much this
kiṁ jñātena tavārjuna
what (use) by knowing for you Arjuna
viṣṭabhyāham idaṁ kṛtsnam
pervading I this entire
ekāṁśena sthito jagat
by one portion I stand the universe

20 "But what need have you, Arjuna, of all this detailed knowledge? By one portion of Myself I pervade and support this entire universe." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Arjuna, what more need I say? With one part of Myself, as Paramātmā, I have entered the whole universe and abide in it.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān explained to Arjuna in many ways the truth of His relationship with all that exists (*sambandha-tattva*), and in this verse He states it briefly.

atha vā (or else) **arjuna** (O Arjuna) **bahunā** (with many details, taught one by one) **jñātena kim** (what use is it [for you] to know? That is, enough) **idam** (this

[made of spirit and matter]) **kṛtsnam** (entire) **jagat** (universe) **ekāṁśena** (with one part [the part called the Puruṣa, the indwelling Lord of *prakṛti* and the rest]) **viṣṭabhya** (supporting [as its foundation, bearing it; as its overseer, governing it; as its controller, subduing it; as the all-pervading one, pervading it]), **aham** (I [Bhagavān]) **sthitaḥ** (abide).

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.9.42)

তমিমমহমজং শরীরভাজাং
হৃদি হৃদি ধিষ্ঠিতমাত্মকল্পিতানাম্ ।
প্রতিদৃশমিব নৈকধার্কমেকং
সমধিগতোঽস্মি বিধূতভেদমোহঃ ॥ ২১ ॥

tam imam aham ajaṁ śarīra-bhājāṁ
Him this I the unborn of the embodied
hṛdi hṛdi dhiṣṭhitam ātma-kalpitānām
in heart in heart abiding created by Himself
prati-dṛśam iva naikadhārkam ekaṁ
to each eye as if in many ways the sun one
samadhigato 'smi vidhūta-bheda-mohaḥ
have attained I having cast off of difference the illusion

21 (Grandsire Bhīṣma said:) "O Śrī Kṛṣṇa! Having cast off the illusion of 'difference' between all Your forms, I have attained You, the Unborn, who abide in the heart of each of the embodied beings You have created — like the one sun, which each eye sees in its own way." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.9.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhīṣma said: "O Kṛṣṇa, one and the same sun appears to each eye as a separate, distinct object. So too Paramātmā, Your part, abides in the heart of every embodied being, and people take Him to be a separate truth. But when they become *ātma-kalpita* — Your own, that is, when they know themselves to be Your servants — this delusion of difference vanishes. I have come to know Paramātmā as Your part, and so I too am free from the delusion of difference: I have gained knowledge of You, who are unborn in Your own nature (*svarūpa*)."[11]

Anubhāṣya.

Yudhiṣṭhira went to Bhīṣma wishing to ask him about dharma, and Śrī Kṛṣṇa followed him on Arjuna's chariot. Other divine and brahminical sages (*devarṣis* and *brahmarṣis*) also gathered there to see Bhīṣma. Bhīṣma answered some of Yudhiṣṭhira's questions. Then, when the time of his departure came, he praised Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who stood before him, in many verses; this verse is one of them.

prati-dṛśam (to each eye [of beings in different places]) **naikadhā** (in many ways [because they abide in different places]), **ekam arkam iva** (like the one sun) **ātma-kalpitānām** (created by Himself) **śarīra-bhājām** (of the embodied) **hṛdi hṛdi** (in each heart) **dhiṣṭhitam** (abiding), **tam imam ajam** (this Unborn One [Śrī Kṛṣṇa]) **vidhūta-bheda-mohaḥ** (one whose delusion of difference is cast off [*vidhūta*, removed]. This delusion is the idea that Bhagavān's name, form, qualities and pastimes are different from Him. It shows itself as a perception of multiplicity: one imagines that Bhagavān's form divides into different forms — *prakāśas* and *vilāsa-mūrtis* — in order to become all-pervading) **aham** (I) **samadhigataḥ asmi** (have fully realised [attained]).

(3) Examining Bhagavān —

সেই ত' গোবিন্দ সাক্ষাচ্চৈতন্য গোসাঞি ।
জীব নিস্তারিতে ঐছে দয়ালু আর নাই ॥ ২২ ॥

sei ta' govinda sākṣāc caitanya gosāñi
that indeed Govinda directly Caitanya the Lord
jīva nistārite aiche dayālu āra nāi
the souls in delivering so merciful another there is not

22 That very Govinda is Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi Himself. There is none so merciful in delivering the souls.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By using the word *sākṣāt* (directly, in person) here, the author establishes that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Govinda Himself, not a *prakāśa* or *vilāsa* of Govinda.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Caitanya Upaniṣad*: "Gaura is the Self of all, the Great Person, the Great Soul, the great yogī; He is beyond the three modes and is the embodiment of pure goodness (*sattva*). He will reveal devotion in the world." In the *Śvetāśvatara*: "He

is the supreme great Lord of lords, the supreme Deity of deities, the supreme Master of masters, higher than the highest. We know Him as God, the Lord of the worlds, worthy of praise." "Truly, the great Lord is the Puruṣa. He impels the intelligence towards this purest attainment; He is the Ruler, the imperishable Light." "When the seer sees the golden-coloured Creator, the Lord, the Puruṣa, the source of Brahman…" "O Great Person! I bow to Your lotus feet. They are always to be meditated on; they destroy humiliation and fulfil desires; they are the refuge of the holy places, praised by Śiva and Brahmā, and they are the shelter. They destroy the sufferings of servants; O Protector of the surrendered, they are the boat on the ocean of birth and death. O most righteous One! At the word of a worthy one You gave up a glorious kingdom, so hard to renounce and coveted even by the gods, and went to the forest; You ran after the illusory deer that Your beloved desired…" "Thus, O Great Person, You descend as human, animal, sage, demigod and fish, sustain the worlds, slay the enemies of the world and protect the dharma proper to each age. But in Kali You came concealed (*channa*), and therefore You are Triyuga" — these are Prahlāda's words.[15]

There is no need to cite here the evidence already quoted in the *Caritāmṛta*. In the *Kṛṣṇa-yāmala*: "In the holy place Navadvīpa I shall become the son of Śacī." In the *Brahma-yāmala*: "Or else I shall descend to earth in the form of My devotee and appear in Māyā[16] in the Kali age, when saṅkīrtana begins." In the *Vāyu Purāṇa*: "When saṅkīrtana begins in the Kali age, I shall become the son of Śacī." In the *Ananta-saṁhitā*: "That same Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa, the beloved of Rādhikā's life, who at the beginning of creation is the Lord of the universe, became Gaura, O Maheśvarī!" And so on.

Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma, is described in all the scriptures —

পরব্যোমেতে বৈসে নারায়ণ নাম ৷
ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যপূর্ণ লক্ষ্মীকান্ত ভগবান্ ॥ ২৩ ॥

para-vyomete vaise nārāyaṇa nāma
in the spiritual sky dwells Nārāyaṇa named
ṣaḍ-aiśvarya-pūrṇa lakṣmī-kānta bhagavān
with six opulences full of Lakṣmī the beloved Bhagavān

23 In the spiritual sky dwells the Lord called Nārāyaṇa — Bhagavān, full in the six opulences, the beloved of Lakṣmī.

বেদ, ভাগবত, উপনিষদ্, আগম ।
'পূর্ণতত্ত্ব' যাঁরে কহে, নাহি যাঁর সম ॥ ২৪ ॥

veda, bhāgavata, upaniṣad, āgama
the Vedas, the Bhāgavata, the Upaniṣads, the Āgamas
'pūrṇa-tattva' yāṁre kahe, nāhi yāṁra sama
'the complete Truth' whom they call, there is not to whom an equal

24 He whom the Vedas, the *Bhāgavatam*, the Upaniṣads and the Āgamas call "the complete Truth", and who has no equal —

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Ṛg-veda-saṁhitā* (1.22.20): "The sages always see that supreme abode of Viṣṇu, like an eye spread across the sky," and so on. In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.3.34–35): "You are the best knowers of Brahman; tell us, then, of the foundation of Brahman, the Paramātmā called Nārāyaṇa." "It is the cause of the creation, maintenance and dissolution of this world, but Itself has no cause. It is present in dreaming, waking and deep sleep, and also beyond them. By It the body, the senses, the life air and the heart come alive and act. Know It as the Supreme, O king." In the *Nārāyaṇa-atharvaśira Upaniṣad*: "From Nārāyaṇa alone everything is born, by Nārāyaṇa it is set in motion, in Nārāyaṇa it dissolves. Nārāyaṇa is eternal. All this is Nārāyaṇa alone — all that has been and all that will be. Pure is the one God Nārāyaṇa, and there is no second." In the *Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad*: "He from whom the mother of the world was born." In the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra*: "The Paramātmā is the Lord Hari."

A difference in vision brings a difference in what is seen; a difference in means brings a difference in how the goal is perceived —

ভক্তিযোগে ভক্ত পায় যাঁহার দর্শন ।
সূর্য্য যেন সবিগ্রহ দেখে দেবগণ ॥ ২৫ ॥

bhakti-yoge bhakta pāya yāṁhāra darśana
through bhakti-yoga the devotees attain whose sight
sūrya yena savigraha dekhe deva-gaṇa
the sun as with its form see the gods

25 Him the devotees behold through bhakti-yoga, as the gods behold the sun in its own form.

জ্ঞান-যোগ-মার্গে তাঁরে ভজে যেই সব ।
ব্রহ্ম-আত্মরূপে তাঁরে করে অনুভব ॥ ২৬ ॥

jñāna-yoga-mārge tāṁre bhaje yei saba
on the path of knowledge and yoga Him worship who all
brahma-ātma-rūpe tāṁre kare anubhava
as Brahman and the Self Him they realise

26 Those who worship Him on the paths of knowledge and yoga realise Him as Brahman and as the Supersoul.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān's eternal form (*nitya-vigraha*) cannot be seen with the material senses or by the efforts of knowledge. Only devotees, through *bhakti-yoga*, that is, through *bhakti-rati*, the loving attraction of devotion, become fit to see it. Here is an example. The sun is an object that has a form. Ordinary eyes of flesh, or demoniac eyes, cannot see that form; but the divine eyes of the demigods pierce the network of the sun's rays and see it. Those who seek Bhagavān on the path of knowledge and on the path of yoga can follow only Brahman, the network of rays of the eternal form, and Paramātmā, His part. They do not become fit to see the spiritual eternal form.

উপাসনা-ভেদে জানি ঈশ্বর-মহিমা ।
অতএব সূর্য্য তাঁর দিয়ে ত' উপমা ॥ ২৭ ॥

upāsanā-bhede jāni īśvara-mahimā
by the difference of worship I know of the Lord the greatness
ataeva sūrya tāṁra diye ta' upamā
therefore the sun for Him is given indeed as a simile

27 By the differences in worship we know the greatness of the Lord; that is why He is compared to the sun.

(1) Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are one, yet differ in Their pastimes —

সেই নারায়ণ কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ অভেদ ।
একই বিগ্রহ, কিন্তু আকার-বিভেদ ॥ ২৮ ॥

sei nārāyaṇa kṛṣṇera svarūpa abheda
that Nārāyaṇa from Kṛṣṇa's own form not different
ekai vigraha, kintu ākāra-vibheda
one and the same form, but of shape difference

28 That Nārāyaṇa is not different from Kṛṣṇa's own form: They are one and the same Person, differing only in shape.

ইঁহো ত' দ্বিভুজ, তিঁহো ধরে চারি হাত ।
ইঁহো বেণু ধরে, তিঁহো চক্রাদিক সাথ ॥ ২৯ ॥

iṁho ta' dvi-bhuja, tiṁho dhare cāri hāta
this One indeed two-armed, that One holds four hands
iṁho veṇu dhare, tiṁho cakrādika sātha
this One the flute holds, that One the disc and the rest with

29 This One has two arms, while that One has four; this One holds the flute, that One the disc and the other emblems.[3]

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.14.14)

নারায়ণস্ত্বং ন হি সর্ব্বদেহিনা-
মাত্মাস্যধীশাখিললোকসাক্ষী ।
নারায়ণোঽঙ্গং নরভূ-জলায়না-
ত্তচ্চাপি সত্যং ন তবৈব মায়া ॥ ৩০ ॥

nārāyaṇas tvaṁ na hi sarva-dehinām
Nārāyaṇa You not indeed of all the embodied
ātmāsy adhīśākhila-loka-sākṣī
the Self You are O Lord of all worlds the witness
nārāyaṇo 'ṅgaṁ nara-bhū-jalāyanāt
Nārāyaṇa (Your) limb from Nara born waters abode
tac cāpi satyaṁ na tavaiva māyā
that also true not Your indeed māyā

30 "Are You not Nārāyaṇa? For You are the Self of all embodied beings, O Lord, and the witness of all the worlds. Nārāyaṇa is Your portion — so called because His abode is the waters born of Nara; and that too is true, not Your māyā." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Adhīśa, Supreme Lord, You are the witness of all the worlds. You are the Self of all embodied beings, that is, what is dearest to them; are You not, then, my father Nārāyaṇa? The water born of Nara is called *nāra*, and He whose resting place (*ayana*) is in it is Nārāyaṇa. He is Your *aṅga*, that is, Your part. None of Your parts — Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Kṣīrodaśāyī and Garbhodaśāyī — is subject to māyā: They are the masters of māyā, the supreme Truth beyond māyā.

Anubhāṣya.
Brahmā stole the calves, then came to understand the truth about Śrī Kṛṣṇa and offered Him praise; this is one of the verses of that prayer.

adhīśa (O Adhīśa [Lord, endowed with majesty greater than that of the three *puruṣa-avatāras*]!) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** (are Nārāyaṇa (He from whom comes the movement [*ayana*], that is, the activity, of *nāra*)) **sarva-dehinām** (of all the embodied [of all living beings]) **ātmā** (the Self; [and so]) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** ((He whose shelter [*ayana*] is *nāra*, that is, the totality of jīvas: the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Ocean of Milk)) **asi na hi** (are You not?) **akhila-loka-sākṣī** (the witness of all the worlds [the indwelling Lord of the aggregate [of jīvas]]) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** ((He who knows [*ayase*] *nāra*: the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Garbhodaka)) **nara-bhū-jalāyanāt** ([because His shelter is the *arthas*, that is, the twenty-four elements that arose from Nara, the Paramātmā, and also the water born of Nara]) **nārāyaṇaḥ** (Nārāyaṇa [that celebrated first *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Kāraṇodaka] —) **saḥ api** (He too)

tava aṅgam (is Your *aṅga* [part]) **tat ca api satyam** (And this too is true), **na tava eva māyā** (and not at all māyā [not transient, like what belongs to māyā]).

(Even when You descend as an avatāra, māyā cannot touch Your spiritual body. O Kṛṣṇa, You are the original Nārāyaṇa, and the Puruṣa and the other avatāras are Your parts; You alone are the whole. These avatāras are limbs (*aṅgas*), and You are the possessor of the limbs (*aṅgī*) — such is my conviction.)

Explanation of the verse —

শিশু বৎস হরি' ব্রহ্মা করি' অপরাধ ।
অপরাধ ক্ষমাইতে মাগেন প্রসাদ ॥ ৩১ ॥

śiśu vatsa hari' brahmā kari' aparādha
the boys calves having stolen Brahmā having committed offence
aparādha kṣamāite māgena prasāda
the offence to have forgiven begs for mercy

31 Having stolen the boys and the calves, Brahmā had committed an offence; to have it forgiven, he begged for mercy:

Since Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa, all the puruṣa-avatāras are contained in Him —

তোমার নাভিপদ্ম হৈতে আমার জন্মোদয় ।
তুমি পিতা-মাতা, আমি তোমার তনয় ॥ ৩২ ॥

tomāra nābhi-padma haite āmāra janmodaya
Your of the navel from the lotus my birth
tumi pitā-mātā, āmi tomāra tanaya
You father and mother, I Your son

32 "From the lotus of Your navel I was born; You are my father and mother, and I am Your son.

পিতা মাতা বালকের না লয় অপরাধ ।
অপরাধ ক্ষম, মোরে করহ প্রসাদ ॥ ৩৩ ॥

pitā mātā bālakera nā laya aparādha
father mother of a child do not take the offences
aparādha kṣama, more karaha prasāda
the offence forgive, to me show mercy

33 A father and mother do not hold a child's offences against him. Forgive my offence and be merciful to me."

কৃষ্ণ কহেন — ব্রহ্মা, তোমার পিতা নারায়ণ ।
আমি গোপ, তুমি কৈছে আমার নন্দন ॥ ৩৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa kahena — brahmā, tomāra pitā nārāyaṇa
Kṛṣṇa says — Brahmā, your father Nārāyaṇa
āmi gopa, tumi kaiche āmāra nandana
I a cowherd, you how My son

34 Kṛṣṇa said: "Brahmā, your father is Nārāyaṇa. I am a cowherd boy — how can you be My son?"

The first proof —

ব্রহ্মা বলেন, তুমি কি না হও নারায়ণ ।
তুমি নারায়ণ — শুন তাহার কারণ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

brahmā balena, tumi ki nā hao nārāyaṇa
Brahmā says, You whether not are Nārāyaṇa
tumi nārāyaṇa — śuna tāhāra kāraṇa
You Nārāyaṇa — hear of that the reason

35 Brahmā said: "Are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are Nārāyaṇa — hear the reason.

প্রাকৃতাপ্রাকৃত-সৃষ্ট্যে যত জীবরূপ ।
তাহার যে আত্মা তুমি মূল-স্বরূপ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

prākṛtāprākṛta-sṛṣṭye yata jīva-rūpa
in the material and spiritual creation all living forms
tāhāra ye ātmā tumi mūla-svarūpa
their who the Self You the original form

36 You are the Self of all living beings, as many as there are in the material and spiritual creation; You are their original source.[4]

Anubhāṣya.
All the various things that have arisen from *prakṛti* through the modes are material (*prākṛta*). There are also the eternal varieties of spiritual *vilāsa*, which the modes cannot disturb; this is the transcendental (*aprākṛta*) creation. The hosts of liberated jīvas who belong to the transcendental manifestation are devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa. The conditioned jīvas are subject to time, are under the sway of the three modes and belong to the material creation. The liberated jīvas of the transcendental manifestation are always engaged in serving Kṛṣṇa, while the material jīvas are always bound to taste happiness and distress. Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original *svarūpa* of both the liberated and the conditioned jīvas. From His marginal potency (*taṭastha-śakti*) come various jīvas; some are turned towards service and others away from it, and all abide in various forms. When liberated, the jīva serves Bhagavān in the transcendental kingdom: in the five different *rasas* he abides under the protection of the *āśraya* (the shelter). In the kingdom of enjoyment, however, he is gripped by ignorance (*avidyā*): he thinks himself the enjoyer and sees in other things a "woman" (*yoṣid-buddhi*), that is, an object to enjoy. Both kinds of jīvas are manifestations of the transformation of the *taṭastha-śakti*; both depend on the Possessor of potency.

পৃথ্বী যৈছে ঘটকুলের কারণ আশ্রয়।
জীবের নিদান তুমি, তুমি সর্ব্বাশ্রয় ॥ ৩৭ ॥

pṛthvī yaiche ghaṭa-kulera kāraṇa āśraya
the earth as of the pots of the multitude the cause the support
jīvera nidāna tumi, tumi sarvāśraya
of the souls the cause You, You of all the shelter

37 As the earth is the cause and the support of all earthen pots, so You are the cause of all souls, and You are the shelter of all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The material (*prākṛta*) creation lies within the bounds of māyā, *prakṛti*. "Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence and false ego — these are the eight divisions of My separated *prakṛti*. This is the lower…" (*Bhagavad-gītā* 7.4–5). According to these words of the *Gītā*, all of it belongs to māyā, that is, is material: both the subtle world — mind, intelligence and false ego — and the five great elements beginning with earth. The pure jīva and the spiritual world are transcendental (*aprākṛta*). There are two worlds, the material and the transcendental, and two kinds of jīvas, the conditioned and the pure; You are the Self of them all, and therefore their original *svarūpa*. Earth is the cause and shelter of all pots; so too You alone are the *nidāna* of the jīvas, that is, their cause and shelter.

Anubhāṣya.

All-pervading clay is the material cause of the various pots it pervades. So too from Bhagavān, nondual knowledge, all the hosts of jīvas are eternally manifest, like pots. Bhagavān, the cause of all causes, always abides [in them] as the cause of the jīvas. The Śruti "The eternal among the eternal, the conscious among the conscious"[17] shows that the shelter of all that exists is the Supreme Truth.

The Viśiṣṭādvaitins define the subject of Vedānta like this. The jīva, the possessor of the subtle and gross bodies, is seen in three states. So too the spiritual and the material worlds appear in two states, separately from Bhagavān's *svarūpa*, and so establish His nonduality endowed with distinguishing features. The spiritual world is full of Bhagavān's associates, and the material world is the field of enjoyment for the conditioned jīvas, who have turned away from Bhagavān. Bhagavān's internal potency is the cause of the variety of His retinue; His external potency has created the world born of the material modes. The material world is the gross, external part of Bhagavān's body, and the world of jīvas the subtle part of His body. Bhagavān is the possessor (*aṅgī*) of both kinds of parts. Gauḍīya philosophy (*Gauḍīya-darśana*) has established inconceivable oneness and difference (*acintya-bhedābheda*), present at once in the relation of cause and effect: between the Possessor of His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the two worlds, which are transformations of the spiritual and the non-spiritual potencies.

'নার' শব্দে কহে সর্ব্বজীবের নিচয়।
'অয়ন' শব্দেতে কহে তাহার আশ্রয় ॥ ৩৮ ॥

'nāra' śabde kahe sarva-jīvera nicaya
'nāra' by the word is meant of all souls the aggregate
'ayana' śabdete kahe tāhāra āśraya
'ayana' by the word is meant their shelter

38 The word *nāra* means the aggregate of all souls, and the word *ayana* means their shelter.

অতএব তুমি হও মূল নারায়ণ ।
এই এক হেতু, শুন দ্বিতীয় কারণ ॥ ৩৯ ॥

ataeva tumi hao mūla nārāyaṇa
therefore You are the original Nārāyaṇa
ei eka hetu, śuna dvitīya kāraṇa
this one reason, hear the second reason

39 Therefore You are the original Nārāyaṇa. That is one reason; hear now the second.

The second proof —

জীবের ঈশ্বর — পুরুষাদি অবতার ।
তাঁহা সবা হৈতে তোমার ঐশ্বর্য্য অপার ॥ ৪০ ॥

jīvera īśvara — puruṣādi avatāra
of the souls the lords — the Puruṣas and other avatāras
tāṁhā sabā haite tomāra aiśvarya apāra
Them all than Your majesty unlimited

40 The Puruṣas and the other avatāras are the lords of the souls, but Your majesty is unlimited, greater than that of Them all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The Puruṣa and the other avatāras" are the three *puruṣa-avatāras*: Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī.

অতএব অধীশ্বর তুমি সর্ব্বপিতা ।
তোমার শক্তিতে তাঁরা জগৎ-রক্ষিতা ॥ ৪১ ॥

ataeva adhīśvara tumi sarva-pitā
therefore the supreme Lord You of all the father
tomāra śaktite tāṁrā jagat-rakṣitā
by Your power They of the world the protectors

41 Therefore You are the supreme Lord, the father of all; it is by Your power that They protect the world.

নারের অয়ন যাতে করহ পালন ।
অতএব হও তুমি মূল নারায়ণ ॥ ৪২ ॥

nārera ayana yāte karaha pālana
of the nāras the shelters since You do protection
ataeva hao tumi mūla nārāyaṇa
therefore are You the original Nārāyaṇa

42 Since You protect those who are the shelter of the nāras, You are the original Nārāyaṇa.

The third proof —

তৃতীয় কারণ শুন শ্রীভগবান্ ।
অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড বহু বৈকুণ্ঠাদি ধাম ॥ ৪৩ ॥

tṛtīya kāraṇa śuna śrī-bhagavān
the third reason hear O Śrī Bhagavān
ananta brahmāṇḍa bahu vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma
unlimited universes many Vaikuṇṭhas and other abodes

43 Hear the third reason, O Śrī Bhagavān. There are unlimited universes and many abodes — the Vaikuṇṭhas and others.

ইথে যত জীব, তার ত্রৈকালিক কর্ম্ম ।
তাহা দেখ, সাক্ষী তুমি, জান সব মর্ম্ম ॥ ৪৪ ॥

ithe yata jīva, tāra trai-kālika karma
in them all beings, their of the three times deeds
tāhā dekha, sākṣī tumi, jāna saba marma
that You see, the witness You, You know of all the essence

44 All the beings in them, and their deeds in past, present and future — You see it all; You are the witness, You know the heart of everything.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ithe (in them) means in the material multitudes of universes and in the transcendental abodes, Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. You are the one witness, that is, the seer, of all the deeds of the conditioned and the pure jīvas — past, future and present.

তোমার দর্শনে সর্ব্ব জগতের স্থিতি ।
তুমি না দেখিলে কার নাহি স্থিতি গতি ॥ ৪৫ ॥

tomāra darśane sarva jagatera sthiti
by Your sight of all worlds the existence
tumi nā dekhile kāra nāhi sthiti gati
You not if You see — of anyone is not rest motion

45 By Your glance all the worlds exist; if You did not look on them, nothing could either stand or move.

নারের অয়ন যাতে কর দরশন ।
তাহাতেও হও তুমি মূল নারায়ণ ॥ ৪৬ ॥

nārera ayana yāte kara daraśana
of the nāras the ways since You do seeing
tāhāteo hao tumi mūla nārāyaṇa
by that also are You the original Nārāyaṇa

46 Since You see the ways of all the nāras, by that too You are the original Nārāyaṇa.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Yāte means “because”: because You see the jīvas, You are Nārāyaṇa, the shelter (*ayana*) of *nāra*. Brahmā establishes by three arguments that Kṛṣṇa is the original

Nārāyaṇa. First: Kṛṣṇa is the *nidāna* (cause) and shelter of all jīvas, and therefore He is the original Nārāyaṇa. Second: the Lord of all jīvas is the Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Puruṣa; the Self of the aggregate jīva, that is, of Hiraṇyagarbha, is the Garbhodaśāyī Puruṣa; and the indwelling Lord, the Self of the individual jīva, is the Kṣīrodaśāyī Puruṣa. These three Puruṣas and Their avatāras receive Their power from Kṛṣṇa; He is its original source and thus the shelter of *nāra*, and therefore He is the original Nārāyaṇa. Third: in countless universes, in Vaikuṇṭha and in the other abodes, Kṛṣṇa is the witness of the deeds of the conditioned and the pure jīvas in all three times; thus He is the shelter of *nāra*, and therefore the original Nārāyaṇa.

কৃষ্ণ কহেন — ব্রহ্মা, তোমার না বুঝি বচন ।
জীব-হৃদি, জলে বৈসে সেই নারায়ণ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa kahena — brahmā, tomāra nā bujhi vacana
Kṛṣṇa says — Brahmā, your not I understand words
jīva-hṛdi, jale vaise sei nārāyaṇa
in the hearts of beings, in the waters dwells that Nārāyaṇa

47 Kṛṣṇa said: "Brahmā, I do not understand your words. Nārāyaṇa is He who dwells in the hearts of living beings and in the waters."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Jīva-hṛdi means in the heart of the individual and of the aggregate jīva. *Jale* (in the water) means in the Kāraṇābdhi, the Garbhodaka and the Kṣīrodaka.

ব্রহ্মা কহে — জলে জীবে যেই নারায়ণ ।
সে সব তোমার অংশ, — এ সত্য বচন ॥ ৪৮ ॥

brahmā kahe — jale jīve yei nārāyaṇa
Brahmā says — in the waters in beings who Nārāyaṇa
se saba tomāra aṁśa, — e satya vacana
They all Your portions, — this true word

48 Brahmā said: "The Nārāyaṇa who lies in the waters and dwells in the beings — in all these forms He is Your portion. What I say is true.

The marks of the three puruṣa-avatāras —

কারণাব্ধি-গর্ভোদক-ক্ষীরোদকশায়ী ।
মায়াদ্বারা সৃষ্টি করে, তাতে সব মায়ী ॥ ৪৯ ॥

kāraṇābdhi-garbhodaka-kṣīrodaka-śāyī
of the Causal ocean Garbhodaka Kṣīrodaka who lie
māyā-dvārā sṛṣṭi kare, tāte saba māyī
through māyā creation They do, therefore all masters of māyā

49 Kāraṇodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu create through māyā; therefore all of Them are *māyī*, masters of māyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Tāte saba māyī: because these three Puruṣas create through māyā, They are *māyī*, that is, the masters of māyā.

সেই তিন জলশায়ী সর্ব্ব-অন্তর্য্যামী ।
ব্রহ্মাণ্ডবৃন্দের আত্মা যে পুরুষ-নামী ॥ ৫০ ॥

sei tina jala-śāyī sarva-antaryāmī
those three who lie on the waters of all the Indwellers
brahmāṇḍa-vṛndera ātmā ye puruṣa-nāmī
of the universes of the multitude the Self who Puruṣa named

50 These three, who lie on the waters, dwell within all as the Supersoul: They who are called Puruṣas are the Self of all the universes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ye puruṣa-nāmī means "They whose name is Puruṣa."

হিরণ্যগর্ভের আত্মা গর্ভোদকশায়ী ।
ব্যষ্টিজীব-অন্তর্য্যামী ক্ষীরোদকশায়ী ॥ ৫১ ॥

hiraṇya-garbhera ātmā garbhodaka-śāyī
of Hiraṇyagarbha the Self Garbhodakaśāyī
vyaṣṭi-jīva-antaryāmī kṣīrodaka-śāyī
of the individual being the Indweller Kṣīrodakaśāyī

51 Garbhodakaśāyī is the Self of Hiraṇyagarbha, and Kṣīrodakaśāyī is the Indweller of each individual being.

এ সভার দর্শনে ত' আছে মায়াগন্ধ ।
তুরীয় কৃষ্ণের নাহি মায়ার সম্বন্ধ ॥ ৫২ ॥

e sabhāra darśane ta' āche māyā-gandha
of Them all in the glance indeed there is of māyā a trace
turīya kṛṣṇera nāhi māyāra sambandha
of the fourth Kṛṣṇa there is not with māyā connection

52 They glance upon māyā, and in this there is, as it were, a trace of māyā; but Kṛṣṇa, who abides in the fourth state (*turīya*), has no connection with māyā at all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hiraṇyagarbha is the aggregate jīva; his indwelling Lord is Garbhodakaśāyī. The indwelling Lord of the *vyaṣṭi*, that is, of each separate jīva, is the Puruṣa Kṣīrodakaśāyī. The Puruṣa beyond these three Puruṣas is *turīya*, that is, the fourth. He is Kṛṣṇacandra's *vilāsa-mūrti*, Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma; in Him there is not even a trace of māyā.

(from the Bhāvārtha-dīpikā on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.15.16)

বিরাট্ হিরণ্যগর্ভশ্চ কারণং চেত্যুপাধয়ঃ ।
ঈশস্য যৎ ত্রিভির্হীনং তুরীয়ং তৎ প্রচক্ষতে ॥ ৫৩ ॥

virāṭ hiraṇya-garbhaś ca
Virāṭ Hiraṇyagarbha and
kāraṇaṁ cety upādhayaḥ
Kāraṇa thus designations
īśasya yat tribhir hīnaṁ
of the Lord that which of the three devoid
turīyaṁ tat pracakṣate
the fourth that they call

53 "Virāṭ, Hiraṇyagarbha and Kāraṇa are designations of the Lord; that which is free from these three is called the fourth (*turīya*)." (Śrīdhara

Svāmī's commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.15.16)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Virāṭ, Hiraṇyagarbha and Kāraṇa are all designations (*upādhis*) connected with māyā. The truth free of *upādhis* is *turīya*, the fourth.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīdhara Svāmī quotes this verse in his commentary to explain the word *turīya*.

virāṭ ([the gross]), **hiraṇya-garbhaḥ** ([the subtle]) **ca** (and) **kāraṇam** ([ignorance, or *prakṛti*] —) **iti** ([these]) **īśasya** (of the Lord [the *puruṣa-avatāra*, creator of the *mahat-tattva*]) **upādhayaḥ** (are the *upādhis* [particular manifestations]) **yat** (That which) **tribhiḥ** (by [these] three [*upādhis*]) **hīnam** (is untouched [not connected with them]), **tat** (that [state]) **turīyam** (the fourth [Vaikuṇṭha, beyond the three Puruṣas]) **pracakṣate** (they call).

যদ্যপি তিনের মায়া লইয়া ব্যবহার ।
তথাপি তৎস্পর্শ নাহি, সভে মায়া-পার ॥ ৫৪ ॥

yadyapi tinera māyā laiyā vyavahāra
although of the three with māyā having to do dealings
tathāpi tat-sparśa nāhi, sabhe māyā-pāra
yet its touch is not, all beyond māyā

54 Although the three have dealings with māyā, she does not touch Them: all of Them are beyond māyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hiraṇyagarbha and the rest — the aggregate and the individual jīvas — are subject to māyā. The three Puruṣas mentioned have dealings with māyā, yet They are beyond it. They are the truth that rules over māyā: They glance at māyā but do not touch it.

To descend into the material world and remain beyond it — this is the very nature of Bhagavān — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.11.38)

এতদীশনমীশস্য প্রকৃতিস্থোঽপি তদ্গুণৈঃ ।
ন যুজ্যতে সদাত্মস্থৈর্যথা বুদ্ধিস্তদাশ্রয়া ॥ ৫৫ ॥

etad īśanam īśasya
this the lordship of the Lord
prakṛti-stho 'pi tad-guṇaiḥ
in material nature abiding though by its qualities
na yujyate sadātma-sthair
not is affected ever abiding in Him
yathā buddhis tad-āśrayā
as the intelligence sheltered in Him

55 "This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within material nature, He is never affected by its qualities — just as the intelligence of those who have taken shelter of Him is not affected." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.11.38)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord's lordship consists in just this: He abides in *prakṛti* yet does not come under the sway of its modes. When the intelligence of a jīva bound by māyā takes shelter of the Lord (*Īśa*), it does not join with the modes of māyā even when near māyā.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa returned to His palace in the city of Dvārakā and spent His time with the queens. There was not even a trace of māyā in His conduct, and Śrī Sūta spoke of it like this:

tad-āśrayā ([sheltered in Śrī Bhagavān, as is that of the great devotees]) **buddhiḥ** (intelligence) **yathā** (just as [though it has somehow come to be in *prakṛti*] [**na yujyate**] does not become bound [to the modes], so [He too]. Or else, by contrast): **tad-āśrayā** ([resting on *prakṛti*]) **buddhiḥ** (intelligence [the knowledge of the jīva]) **yathā** (just as [**yujyate**] becomes bound, so [He] **na** — does not [become bound]) **prakṛti-sthaḥ api** (even while abiding in *prakṛti* [being in the world made of the three modes]), **sadā** (always) **ātma-sthaiḥ** (abiding in Him) **tad-guṇaiḥ** (by its modes) **na yujyate** (is not bound [does not become attached to the material modes]) **etat** ([Just] this) **īśasya** (of the Lord [Bhagavān, all-powerful and beyond māyā]) **īśanam** (is the lordship [*aiśvarya*]).

সেই তিন জনের তুমি পরম আশ্রয় ।
তুমি মূলনারায়ণ — ইথে কি সংশয় ॥ ৫৬ ॥

sei tina janera tumi parama āśraya
those three Persons' You supreme shelter
tumi mūla nārāyaṇa — ithe ki saṁśaya
You the original Nārāyaṇa — in this what doubt

56 You are the supreme shelter of those three; You are the original Nārāyaṇa — what doubt can there be?

Anubhāṣya.

For "those three" — Kṣīrodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu — You are the supreme shelter. Their source is Your *vilāsa-mūrti*, the *catur-vyūha*: Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. From Saṅkarṣaṇa, in the Causal Waters, appears the first *puruṣa-avatāra*, the creator of the *mahat-tattva*, Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī; from Pradyumna, the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, Garbhodakaśāyī; and from Aniruddha, the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, Kṣīrodakaśāyī. Once They appear, They remain under the shelter of Nārāyaṇa alone.

সেই তিনের অংশী পরব্যোম-নারায়ণ ।
তেঁহ তোমার প্রকাশ, তুমি মূল-নারায়ণ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

sei tinera aṁśī paravyoma-nārāyaṇa
of those three the source of the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa
teṁha tomāra prakāśa, tumi mūla-nārāyaṇa
He Your manifestation, You the original Nārāyaṇa

57 The source of those three is the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky. He is Your manifestation (*prakāśa*), and You are the original Nārāyaṇa."[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Aṁśī is the One of whom [another] is a part. The Nārāyaṇa of Paravyoma is the *aṁśī* of the *puruṣa-avatāras*. He is Your secondary manifestation (*prakāśa*) in the form of *vilāsa*.

অতএব ব্রহ্মবাক্যে পরব্যোম-নারায়ণ ।
তেঁহ কৃষ্ণের প্রকাশ — এই তত্ত্ব-বিবরণ ॥ ৫৮ ॥

ataeva brahma-vākye paravyoma-nārāyaṇa
therefore of Brahmā in the words of the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa
teṁha kṛṣṇera prakāśa — ei tattva-vivaraṇa
He Kṛṣṇa's manifestation — this of the truth explanation

58 Thus, by Brahmā's words, the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is a manifestation of Kṛṣṇa. This is the explanation of the truth.[6]

এই শ্লোক তত্ত্ব-লক্ষণ ভাগবত-সার ।
পরিভাষা-রূপে ইহার সর্ব্বত্রাধিকার ॥ ৫৯ ॥

ei śloka tattva-lakṣaṇa bhāgavata-sāra
this verse of the truth characteristic of the Bhāgavata the essence
paribhāṣā-rūpe ihāra sarvatrādhikāra
of a paribhāṣā in the form its everywhere application

59 This verse (2.30), which reveals the characteristics of the Truth, is the essence of the *Bhāgavatam*; as a rule of interpretation (*paribhāṣā*) it applies everywhere.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Paribhāṣā means a [defining] sūtra. *Sarvatrādhikāra*: you will find this mark everywhere in the *Bhāgavatam*.

Anubhāṣya.
"This verse" is the verse *nārāyaṇas tvam.*.. quoted above as number 30.

ব্রহ্ম, আত্মা, ভগবান্ — কৃষ্ণের বিহার ।
এ অর্থ না জানি' মূর্খ অর্থ করে আর ॥ ৬০ ॥

brahma, ātmā, bhagavān — kṛṣṇera vihāra
Brahman, Paramātmā, Bhagavān — of Kṛṣṇa the manifestations
e artha nā jāni' mūrkha artha kare āra
this meaning not knowing the foolish meaning make other

60 Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are manifestations of Kṛṣṇa. Not knowing this meaning, fools interpret otherwise.

Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa is a part of Nārāyaṇa and Nārāyaṇa the whole —

অবতারী নারায়ণ, কৃষ্ণ অবতার ।
তেঁহ চতুর্ভুজ, ইঁহ মনুষ্য-আকার ॥ ৬১ ॥

avatārī nārāyaṇa, kṛṣṇa avatāra
the source of avatāras Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇa an avatāra
teṁha catur-bhuja, iṁha manuṣya-ākāra
That One four-armed, this One of human shape

61 They say: "Nārāyaṇa is the source of the avatāras, and Kṛṣṇa is His avatāra; for That One has four arms, while this One has a human form."

এইমতে নানারূপ করে পূর্ব্বপক্ষ ।
তাহারে নির্জ্জিতে ভাগবত-পদ্য দক্ষ ॥ ৬২ ॥

ei-mate nānā-rūpa kare pūrva-pakṣa
in this way various kinds make objections
tāhāre nirjite bhāgavata-padya dakṣa
them to defeat of the Bhāgavata a verse is expert

62 In this way they raise various objections, but a verse of the *Bhāgavatam* skilfully refutes them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vihāra means *vihāra* in the form of manifestations (*prakāśas*). Fools do not understand this meaning and interpret otherwise, for example: "Nārāyaṇa is the source of the avatāras, and Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra." When such conclusions are put forward as a *pūrvapakṣa* (an opponent's thesis), the verses of the *Bhāgavatam* refute them with special skill.

(2) Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are different — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.11)

বদন্তি তত্তত্ত্ববিদস্তত্ত্বং যজ্‌জ্ঞানমদ্বয়ম্ ।
ব্রহ্মেতি পরমাত্মেতি ভগবানিতি শব্দ্যতে ॥ ৬৩ ॥

vadanti tat tattva-vidas
they call that of truth the knowers
tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
the Truth which knowledge non-dual
brahmeti paramātmeti
Brahman thus Paramātmā thus
bhagavān iti śabdyate
Bhagavān thus is named

63 "The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)[7]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.11.

শুন ভাই, এ শ্লোকার্থ করহ বিচার ।
এক মুখ্যতত্ত্ব, তিন তাহার প্রচার ॥ ৬৪ ॥

śuna bhāi, e ślokārtha karaha vicāra
hear brothers, of this verse's meaning make consideration
eka mukhya-tattva, tina tāhāra pracāra
one principal Truth, three its manifestations

64 Hear, brothers, and consider the meaning of this verse: the principal Truth is one, and It is manifest in three ways.

অদ্বয়জ্ঞান তত্ত্ববস্তু কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
ব্রহ্ম, আত্মা, ভগবান্, — তিন তাঁর রূপ ॥ ৬৫ ॥

advaya-jñāna tattva-vastu kṛṣṇera svarūpa
non-dual knowledge the real Truth Kṛṣṇa's own form
brahma, ātmā, bhagavān, — tina tāṁra rūpa
Brahman, Paramātmā, Bhagavān, — three His forms

65 The non-dual knowledge, the Truth itself, is Kṛṣṇa's own form; Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are His three forms.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In this verse the word *advaya-jñāna* (nondual knowledge) means the original Truth, Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa*.

এই শ্লোকের অর্থে তুমি হৈলা নির্ব্বচন ।
আর এক শুন ভাগবতের বচন ॥ ৬৬ ॥

ei ślokera arthe tumi hailā nirvacana
of this verse by the meaning you became speechless
āra eka śuna bhāgavatera vacana
another one hear of the Bhāgavata statement

66 The meaning of this verse has left you speechless. Now hear another statement of the *Bhāgavatam*.

Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra or a part — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.28)

এতে চাংশকলাঃ পুংসঃ কৃষ্ণস্তু ভগবান্ স্বয়ম্ ।
ইন্দ্রারিব্যাকুলং লোকং মৃড়য়ন্তি যুগে যুগে ॥ ৬৭ ॥

ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ
these and portions and parts of the Puruṣa
kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam
Kṛṣṇa but Bhagavān Himself
indrāri-vyākulaṁ lokaṁ
by the enemies of Indra troubled the world
mṛḍayanti yuge yuge
make happy in age after age

67 "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and the others are parts (*aṁśas*) or parts of parts (*kalās*) of the *puruṣa-avatāra*. But Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. These avatāras protect the world,

oppressed by the Daityas (demons), in age after age.

Anubhāṣya.

After listing Śrī Kṛṣṇa's avatāras, Śrī Sūta concludes with this verse.

ete ([the avatāras named before]) **puṁsaḥ** ([of the *puruṣa-avatāra*]) **aṁśa-kalāḥ** (are parts and *kalās* [parts of parts]) **kṛṣṇaḥ tu** (But Kṛṣṇa) **bhagavān svayam** (is Bhagavān Himself) **indrāri-vyākulam** ([These partial avatāras] [oppressed by the demons]) **lokam** ([the universe]) **yuge yuge** ([in every age, at the proper time]) **mṛḍayanti** ([make happy]).

সব অবতারের করি সামান্য-লক্ষণ ।
তার মধ্যে কৃষ্ণচন্দ্রের করিল গণন ॥ ৬৮ ॥

saba avatārera kari sāmānya-lakṣaṇa
all of the avatāras having made general characteristics
tāra madhye kṛṣṇa-candrera karila gaṇana
their among Kṛṣṇacandra made counting

68 Describing the general characteristics of all the avatāras, he counted Kṛṣṇacandra among them.

তবে সূত গোসাঞি মনে পাঞা বড় ভয় ।
যাঁর যে লক্ষণ তাহা করিল নিশ্চয় ॥ ৬৯ ॥

tabe sūta gosāñi mane pāñā baḍa bhaya
then Sūta Gosāñi in mind feeling great fear
yāṁra ye lakṣaṇa tāhā karila niścaya
of whom which characteristic that made determination

69 Then Sūta Gosāñi, feeling great apprehension in his mind, determined the distinguishing characteristic of each.

অবতার সব — পুরুষের কলা-অংশ ।
স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্ব-অবতংস ॥ ৭০ ॥

avatāra saba — puruṣera kalā-aṁśa
the avatāras all — of the Puruṣa parts portions
svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa sarva-avataṁsa
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa of all the crown

70 All the avatāras are portions and parts of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself, the crown of all.

পূর্ব্বপক্ষ কহে — তোমার ভাল ত' ব্যাখ্যান ।
পরব্যোমে-নারায়ণ স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ॥ ৭১ ॥

pūrva-pakṣa kahe — tomāra bhāla ta' vyākhyāna
the opponent says — your good indeed explanation
paravyome-nārāyaṇa svayaṁ bhagavān
of the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa Himself Bhagavān

71 An opponent says: "Your explanation is fine, but the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is Bhagavān Himself.

তেঁহ আসি' কৃষ্ণরূপে করেন অবতার ।
এই অর্থ শ্লোকে দেখি — কি আর বিচার ॥ ৭২ ॥

teṁha āsi' kṛṣṇa-rūpe karena avatāra
He coming in the form of Kṛṣṇa makes descent
ei artha śloke dekhi — ki āra vicāra
this meaning in the verse I see — what further consideration

72 It is He who comes and descends in the form of Kṛṣṇa. This is the meaning I see in the verse — what more is there to consider?"

(3) Refuting, by the rules of poetics, the view that Kṛṣṇa is a part of Nārāyaṇa —

তারে কহে — কেনে কর কুতর্কানুমান ।
শাস্ত্রবিরুদ্ধার্থ কভু না হয় প্রমাণ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

tāre kahe — kene kara kutarkānumāna
to him I say — why do you of false logic inferences
śāstra-viruddhārtha kabhu nā haya pramāṇa
to scripture contrary meaning ever not is evidence

73 To him I say: "Why do you draw inferences by false logic? A meaning contrary to scripture can never be evidence.

(a rule of poetics, Ekādaśī-tattva 13)

অনুবাদমনুক্ত্বা তু ন বিধেয়মুদীরয়েৎ ।
ন হ্যলব্ধাস্পদং কিঞ্চিৎ কুত্রচিৎ প্রতিতিষ্ঠতি ॥ ৭৪ ॥

anuvādam anuktvā tu
the subject not having stated but
na vidheyam udīrayet
not the predicate one should utter
na hy alabdhāspadaṁ kiñcit
not indeed without a footing anything
kutracit pratitiṣṭhati
anywhere stands

74 'One should not state the predicate without first stating the subject; for nothing that has not found its footing can stand anywhere.' (Ekādaśī-tattva, 13)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In poetics the unknown is called the *vidheya*, and the known the *anuvāda*. Take the sentence "This brāhmaṇa is learned." Everyone knows that this man is a brāhmaṇa; so this is the *anuvāda*. Not everyone knows that the brāhmaṇa is learned; so this is the *vidheya*. If someone states the *vidheya* first without stating the *anuvāda*, his statement has nothing to rest on and cannot stand.

Anubhāṣya.

anuvādam (the *uddeśya*, that is, the known subject) **anuktvā** (without stating) **vidheyam** (the unknown subject) **na udīrayet** (one should not state) **hi** (for) **alabdhāspadam** (that which has not found a footing, its own place) **kiñcit** (anything) **kutracit** (anywhere) **na pratitiṣṭhati** (does not stand firm).

The rule for using the anuvāda and the vidheya —

অনুবাদ না কহিয়া না কহি বিধেয় ।
আগে অনুবাদ কহি, পশ্চাদ্বিধেয় ॥ ৭৫ ॥

anuvāda nā kahiyā nā kahi vidheya
the subject not having stated not one states the predicate
āge anuvāda kahi, paścād vidheya
first the subject one states, afterwards the predicate

75 Without stating the subject one does not state the predicate: first the subject is stated, and afterwards the predicate.

Definition of the anuvāda and the vidheya —

'বিধেয়' কহিয়ে তারে, যে বস্তু অজ্ঞাত ।
'অনুবাদ' কহি তারে, যেই হয় জ্ঞাত ॥ ৭৬ ॥

'vidheya' kahiye tāre, ye vastu ajñāta
'the predicate' one calls that, which thing unknown
'anuvāda' kahi tāre, yei haya jñāta
'the subject' one calls that, which is known

76 That which is unknown is called the predicate (*vidheya*); that which is known is called the subject (*anuvāda*).

An example —

যৈছে কহি, — এই বিপ্র পরম পণ্ডিত ।
বিপ্র — অনুবাদ, ইহার বিধেয় — পাণ্ডিত্য ॥ ৭৭ ॥

yaiche kahi, — ei vipra parama paṇḍita
as we say, — this brāhmaṇa a great scholar
vipra — anuvāda, ihāra vidheya — pāṇḍitya
brāhmaṇa — the subject, its predicate — scholarship

77 For example, we say: "This brāhmaṇa is a great scholar." Here "brāhmaṇa" is the subject, and its predicate is "scholarship".

বিপ্র বলি' জানি, তার পাণ্ডিত্য অজ্ঞাত ।
অতএব বিপ্র আগে, পাণ্ডিত্য পশ্চাৎ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

vipra bali' jāni, tāra pāṇḍitya ajñāta
a brāhmaṇa that he is we know, his scholarship unknown
ataeva vipra āge, pāṇḍitya paścāt
therefore brāhmaṇa first, scholarship afterwards

78 That he is a brāhmaṇa is known, but his scholarship is not; therefore "brāhmaṇa" comes first, and "scholarship" afterwards.

Explaining the verse ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ… by the rule of anuvāda and vidheya, or: Kṛṣṇa is the source of the avatāras —

তৈছে ইঁহ অবতার, সব তাঁর জ্ঞাত ।
কার অবতার — এই বস্তু অবিজ্ঞাত ॥ ৭৯ ॥

taiche iṁha avatāra, saba tāṁra jñāta
so here the avatāras, all They known
kāra avatāra — ei vastu avijñāta
of whom avatāras — this thing unknown

79 In the same way, here the avatāras are all known, but whose avatāras They are — that is unknown.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Iha means "this one" (He). "His avatāras" is a known subject. But whose avatāras they are is not yet known.

'এতে' শব্দে অবতারের আগে অনুবাদ ।
'পুরুষের অংশ' পাছে বিধেয় সংবাদ ॥ ৮০ ॥

'ete' śabde avatārera āge anuvāda
'these' by the word of the avatāras first the subject
'puruṣera aṁśa' pāche vidheya saṁvāda
'of the Puruṣa portions' afterwards of the predicate the statement

80 First, by the word "these", the avatāras are stated as the subject; afterwards the predicate is given: "portions of the Puruṣa".[9]

তৈছে কৃষ্ণ অবতার-ভিতরে হৈল জ্ঞাত ।
তাঁহার বিশেষ-জ্ঞান সেই অবিজ্ঞাত ॥ ৮১ ॥

taiche kṛṣṇa avatāra-bhitare haila jñāta
so Kṛṣṇa among the avatāras became known
tāṁhāra viśeṣa-jñāna sei avijñāta
of Him particular knowledge that unknown

81 So too Kṛṣṇa became known among the avatāras, but the particular knowledge of Him remained unknown.

অতএব 'কৃষ্ণ' শব্দ আগে অনুবাদ ।
'স্বয়ং ভগবত্তা' পিছে বিধেয় সংবাদ ॥ ৮২ ॥

ataeva 'kṛṣṇa' śabda āge anuvāda
therefore 'Kṛṣṇa' the word first the subject
'svayaṁ bhagavattā' piche vidheya saṁvāda
'Bhagavān Himself' afterwards of the predicate the statement

82 Therefore the word "Kṛṣṇa" comes first, as the subject, and afterwards the predicate is stated: that He is "Bhagavān Himself".

কৃষ্ণের স্বয়ং-ভগবত্তা — ইহা হৈল সাধ্য ।
স্বয়ং-ভগবানের কৃষ্ণত্ব হৈল বাধ্য ॥ ৮৩ ॥

kṛṣṇera svayaṁ-bhagavattā — ihā haila sādhya
of Kṛṣṇa being Bhagavān Himself — this became established
svayaṁ-bhagavānera kṛṣṇatva haila bādhya
of Bhagavān Himself being Kṛṣṇa became necessary

83 Thus it is established that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; and it follows of necessity that Bhagavān Himself is Kṛṣṇa.

Otherwise Sūta's words would contradict themselves —

কৃষ্ণ যদি অংশ হৈত, অংশী নারায়ণ ।
তবে বিপরীত হৈত সূতের বচন ॥ ৮৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa yadi aṁśa haita, aṁśī nārāyaṇa
Kṛṣṇa if a portion were, the source Nārāyaṇa
tabe viparīta haita sūtera vacana
then reversed would be of Sūta the statement

84 If Kṛṣṇa were the portion and Nārāyaṇa the source, Sūta's statement would have been the reverse.

নারায়ণ অংশী যেই স্বয়ং-ভগবান্ ।
তেঁহ শ্রীকৃষ্ণ — ঐছে করি তা ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ৮৫ ॥

nārāyaṇa aṁśī yei svayaṁ-bhagavān
Nārāyaṇa the source who Bhagavān Himself
teṁha śrī-kṛṣṇa — aiche kari tā vyākhyāna
He Śrī Kṛṣṇa — so would make that explanation

85 He would have said: "Nārāyaṇa, the source, is Bhagavān Himself, and He is Śrī Kṛṣṇa."

Freedom from the four defects is the mark and distinction of the words of liberated souls —

ভ্রম, প্রমাদ, বিপ্রলিপ্সা, করণাপাটব ।
আর্ষ-বিজ্ঞবাক্যে নাহি দোষ এই সব ॥ ৮৬ ॥

bhrama, pramāda, vipralipsā, karaṇāpāṭava
error, inattention, deceit, imperfection of the senses
ārṣa-vijña-vākye nāhi doṣa ei saba
of the seers wise in the words there are not faults these all

86 In the words of the wise seers there are none of these faults: error, inattention, the wish to deceive, and imperfection of the senses.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the verse *ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ…* the word *ete* (these) names the avatāras; this is its *anuvāda*. That they are parts of the *puruṣa-avatāra* was not known before, and this is stated next as the *vidheya*. In this verse Kṛṣṇa too is mentioned among the avatāras. But the special knowledge about Kṛṣṇa is not yet known, so a *vidheya* is needed. That is why the word "Kṛṣṇa" comes first, as the *anuvāda*, and its *vidheya* is that Kṛṣṇa is "Bhagavān Himself." This is what must be established here (*sādhya*): the reasoning must prove that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Therefore the words *kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam* necessarily (*bādhya*) mean "Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself," and they can have no other meaning. If Nārāyaṇa were the whole and Kṛṣṇa the part, Sūta's words would stand in the reverse order: "Bhagavān Himself is Kṛṣṇa." But *ārṣa*, the wise sayings of the sages, are free from the four defects — *bhrama*, *pramāda*, *vipralipsā* and *karaṇāpāṭava*. That is why the text reads *kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam*. *Bhrama* is false knowledge; *pramāda*, inattention; *vipralipsā*, a mind distracted elsewhere; *karaṇāpāṭava*, the imperfection of the senses.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhrama is false knowledge of a thing, taking it to be what it is not, as when one takes a rope for a snake or mother-of-pearl for silver. **Pramāda** is inattention: one perceives, hears or says one thing as another. **Vipralipsā** is the desire to cheat. **Karaṇāpāṭava** is the imperfection of the senses. For example, the eye cannot see what is far away or make out what is tiny; in jaundice and other diseases the perception of colour (form) is distorted; and the ear cannot hear a sound from far away.

বিরুদ্ধার্থ কহ তুমি, কহিতে কর রোষ ।
তোমার অর্থে অবিমৃষ্টবিধেয়াংশ-দোষ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

viruddhārtha kaha tumi, kahite kara roṣa
contrary meaning speak you, on being told you show anger
tomāra arthe avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa-doṣa
in your interpretation of the unconsidered predicate the fault

87 You speak against the scriptures and grow angry when this is pointed out. The fault in your interpretation is that the predicate is wrongly placed (*avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The defect called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* arises when the *vidheya* is stated before the *anuvāda*. *Avimṛṣṭa* means unconsidered.

Anubhāṣya.

Avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa. The *vidheyāṁśa* is the unknown subject. If it is not set forth as the main thing, the defect called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* arises. Its other name is *vidheya-avimarśa*.

The meaning and definition of the words "Bhagavān Himself" —

যাঁর ভগবত্তা হৈতে অন্যের ভগবত্তা ।
'স্বয়ং ভগবান্' শব্দের তাহাতেই সত্তা ॥ ৮৮ ॥

yāṁra bhagavattā haite anyera bhagavattā
whose Godhood from of others Godhood
'svayaṁ bhagavān' śabdera tāhātei sattā
'Bhagavān Himself' of the word in Him alone the meaning

88 He from whose Godhood the Godhood of all others proceeds — in Him alone the words "Bhagavān Himself" have their meaning.

An example of the source of the avatāras and of the avatāras —

দীপ হৈতে যৈছে বহু দীপের জ্বলন ।
মূল এক দীপ তাহা করিয়ে গণন ॥ ৮৯ ॥

dīpa haite yaiche bahu dīpera jvalana
a lamp from as of many lamps kindling
mūla eka dīpa tāhā kariye gaṇana
original one lamp that I count

89 As many lamps are kindled from one lamp, and that one I count as the original,

Anubhāṣya.

Brahma-saṁhitā, Chapter 5, verse 46: "The flame of a lamp passes to another wick and itself becomes a lamp: it burns separately, yet has the same qualities as its source. In the same way He shines in the form of Viṣṇu. I worship Govinda, the original Puruṣa."

All the *viṣṇu-tattvas* are like lamps: they are full of light and have the same qualities as the original Nārāyaṇa. Yet they are lit from the original lamp. The *viṣṇu-tattvas* are equal to Govinda in being light. But Viriñci (Brahmā) and Śambhu (Śiva) are not so, even though they too are *guṇa-avatāras*. Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī says: "Śambhu, however, is the seat of *tamas*. He is like a thin lamp flame mixed with soot, and so there is no such equality."

তৈছে সব অবতারের কৃষ্ণ সে কারণ ।
আর এক শ্লোক শুন, কুব্যাখ্যা-খণ্ডন ॥ ৯০ ॥

taiche saba avatārera kṛṣṇa se kāraṇa
so of all avatāras Kṛṣṇa indeed the cause
āra eka śloka śuna, kuvyākhyā-khaṇḍana
another one verse hear, of wrong interpretations refutation

90 so Kṛṣṇa is the cause of all the avatāras. Hear another verse, which refutes wrong interpretations.

(4) By the marks of a Purāṇa too, the original shelter is not Nārāyaṇa but Kṛṣṇa — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.10.1–2)

অত্র সর্গো বিসর্গশ্চ স্থানং পোষণমূতয়ঃ ।
মন্বন্তরেশানুকথা নিরোধো মুক্তিরাশ্রয়ঃ ॥ ৯১ ॥

দশমস্য বিশুদ্ধ্যর্থং নবানামিহ লক্ষণম্ ।
বর্ণয়ন্তি মহাত্মানঃ শ্রুতেনার্থেন চাঞ্জসা ॥ ৯২ ॥

atra sargo visargaś ca
here primary creation secondary creation and
sthānaṁ poṣaṇam ūtayaḥ
maintenance favour impulses
manvantareśānukathā
the reigns of Manu narrations of the Lord
nirodho muktir āśrayaḥ
winding up liberation the shelter
daśamasya viśuddhy-arthaṁ
of the tenth for the clear understanding
navānām iha lakṣaṇam
of the nine here the characteristics
varṇayanti mahātmānaḥ
describe the great souls
śrutenārthena cāñjasā
by what is heard by meaning and directly

91–92 "In this *Bhāgavatam* there are ten subjects: primary creation (*sarga*), secondary creation (*visarga*), maintenance (*sthāna*), the Lord's favour to His devotees (*poṣaṇa*), the impulses to action (*ūti*), the reigns of Manu (*manvantara*), the narrations of the Lord (*īśānukathā*), the winding up of the world (*nirodha*), liberation (*mukti*) and the shelter (*āśraya*). To reveal clearly the tenth, the great souls describe here the characteristics of the other nine — sometimes in prayers and narratives, sometimes by direct explanation." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.10.1–2)[10]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *Bhāgavatam* describes ten subjects: *sarga*, *visarga*, *sthāna*, *ūti*, *poṣaṇa*, the *manvantaras*, *īśa-kathā*, *nirodha*, *mukti* and *āśraya*. The tenth truth is *āśraya*, the shelter. To examine it in its purity, the great souls have described the nine preceding marks: in some places through prayers and narratives, and in others through direct reasoning.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the Tenth Canto Śrī Kṛṣṇa is pointed out as the *āśraya-vigraha*, the form who is the shelter of all who seek shelter. I bow to that supreme abode and abode of the universe whose name is Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The meaning is this. In the world there are two

truths: *āśraya*, the shelter, and *āśrita*, that which rests on the shelter. The original truth on which all the *āśrita-tattvas* rest is the *āśraya*. All the truths that exist by resting on it are *āśrita-tattvas*. Everything from *sarga* to *mukti* is *āśrita-tattva*. Thus the *puruṣa-avatāras* and all the avatāras who follow Them, all the potencies, and after them the worlds of jīvas and of matter — all of these rest on that shelter, on Kṛṣṇa. In its prayers and narratives the *Bhāgavatam* examines the *āśraya-tattva* partly indirectly, and in its direct teachings directly. Therefore one must know Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* and His three potencies.

Anubhāṣya.

Parīkṣit asked how the *rājasic* creations arose from the Vairāja Puruṣa. In answer Śukadeva speaks this verse at the start of his explanation of the *catuḥ-ślokī*, the four verses.

atra (here, in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **sargaḥ** (the birth of the elements, the subtle elements, the senses and the intelligence) **visargaḥ** (the imbalance of the modes in Brahmā's creation) **sthānam** (maintenance [*sthiti*]. This is Bhagavān's victory: His excellence shows in the fact that everything created keeps within its bounds) **poṣaṇam** (His mercy to His devotees) **ūtayaḥ** (the desires that impel one to karma) **manvantara** (the *manvantaras*, that is, the dharma of goodness) **īśānukathāḥ** (the narratives of Hari's avatāras) **nirodhaḥ** (withdrawal: the world, together with the potencies, lies down to sleep following the Self) **muktiḥ** (abiding in the pure state) **āśrayaḥ** (the Parabrahman, the Paramātmā, the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution).

These are the ten subjects.

Anubhāṣya.

mahātmānaḥ (the great souls, Vidura and others) **iha** (here, in the Purāṇa *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **daśamasya** (of the tenth, that is, of the *āśraya*) **viśuddhy-artham** (for clear knowledge, that is, knowledge of the truth) **navānām** (of the nine [subjects]) **lakṣaṇam** (the nature) **śrutena** (by the word that names them directly) **añjasā** (directly) **arthena** (by the meaning) **varṇayanti** (describe).

1. *Sarga* — the arising of the five great elements, the five *tanmātras* (subtle elements), the ten senses, the mind, the *mahat-tattva* and false ego (*ahaṅkāra*), both in the form of the Virāṭ and in their own nature. 2. *Visarga* — Brahmā's creation of the moving and the unmoving. 3. *Sthiti* — Bhagavān's victory, His excellence over Brahmā, the creator, and over Śiva, the destroyer. 4. *Poṣaṇa* — Bhagavān's mercy to His devotees. 5. *Ūti* — the desires that impel one to karma. 6. *Manvantara* —

the dharma followed by the jīvas in goodness. 7. *Īśa-kathā* — the narratives of Hari's avatāras and of the *bhāgavatas* (His devotees). 8. *Nirodha* — Hari enters His mystic sleep (*yoga-nidrā*) and lies down together with His potencies, the *upādhis*. 9. *Mukti* — the jīva gives up his gross and subtle forms and abides in the form of a pure jīva or of an associate of the Lord. 10. *Āśraya* — that celebrated Parabrahman and Paramātmā from whom creation and dissolution proceed and in whom the universe is manifest.

আশ্রয় জানিতে কহি এ নব পদার্থ ।
এ নবের উৎপত্তি-হেতু সেই আশ্রয়ার্থ ॥ ৯৩ ॥

āśraya jānite kahi e nava padārtha
the shelter to know I tell these nine categories
e navera utpatti-hetu sei āśrayārtha
of these nine of the origin the cause that the meaning of shelter

93 To make the shelter known I have named these nine categories; the cause from which these nine arise — that is what "the shelter" means.

কৃষ্ণ এক সর্ব্বাশ্রয়, কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্বধাম ।
কৃষ্ণের শরীরে সর্ব্ব-বিশ্বের বিশ্রাম ॥ ৯৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa eka sarvāśraya, kṛṣṇa sarva-dhāma
Kṛṣṇa alone the shelter of all, Kṛṣṇa of all the abode
kṛṣṇera śarīre sarva-viśvera viśrāma
Kṛṣṇa's in the body of all universes the rest

94 Kṛṣṇa alone is the shelter of all; Kṛṣṇa is the abode of all. In Kṛṣṇa's body all the universes rest.

(from the Bhāvārtha-dīpikā on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.1.1)

দশমে দশমং লক্ষ্যমাশ্রিতাশ্রয়বিগ্রহম্ ।
শ্রীকৃষ্ণাখ্যং পরং ধাম জগদ্ধাম নমামি তৎ ॥ ৯৫ ॥

daśame daśamaṁ lakṣyam
in the Tenth (Canto) the tenth the subject
āśritāśraya-vigraham
of the sheltered the shelter the embodiment
śrī-kṛṣṇākhyaṁ paraṁ dhāma
Śrī Kṛṣṇa named the supreme abode
jagad-dhāma namāmi tat
of the world the abode I bow to That

95 "In the Tenth Canto the tenth subject is revealed: the embodiment of the shelter of all who take shelter, the supreme abode named Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the world. To That I bow down." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.1.1)

Anubhāṣya.
daśame (in the Tenth Canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **āśritāśraya-vigraham** (the form who is the shelter of the *āśritas*, the surrendered souls) **daśamam** (the tenth, that is, the *āśraya-tattva*) **lakṣyam** (is pointed out) **tat paraṁ dhāma** (that supreme abode, the best shelter), **jagad-dhāma** (the abode of the universe, the shelter of all), **śrī-kṛṣṇākhyam** (named Śrī Kṛṣṇa), **namāmi** (I worship).

The basis of knowledge about Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ, আর শক্তিত্রয়-জ্ঞান ।
যাঁর হয়, তাঁর নাহি কৃষ্ণেতে অজ্ঞান ॥ ৯৬ ॥

kṛṣṇera svarūpa, āra śakti-traya-jñāna
of Kṛṣṇa own form, and of the three potencies knowledge
yāṁra haya, tāṁra nāhi kṛṣṇete ajñāna
who has, he has not about Kṛṣṇa ignorance

96 One who knows Kṛṣṇa's own form and His three potencies is no longer ignorant of Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The three potencies are the *cit-śakti*, the *jīva-śakti* and the *māyā-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (16): “The one Supreme Truth, by Its own natural inconceivable potency, always abides in four ways: as Its *svarūpa*, as the manifestations of the *svarūpa* (*vaibhava*), as the jīvas and as *pradhāna*. So too the radiance within the sun’s disc abides as the disc itself, as the rays issuing from it, and as their reflection. Inconceivability is the power to accomplish the impossible. Potency is of three kinds: internal, external and marginal. By the internal potency, called *svarūpa-śakti*, the Truth abides in Its full form and in the manifestations of that form, Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. By the marginal potency It abides as the pure jīvas: they are like the rays, spiritual and one with It in nature. By the external potency, called *māyā*, It abides as *pradhāna*: this is Its external, material manifestation, like the play of colours in a reflection. These are the four ways. The jīva is a part of It and therefore the marginal potency, while *pradhāna* belongs to māyā; with this in view the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* counts three potencies. The potency whose work (*karma*) is ignorance (*avidyā*) is named there *avidyā-karma*; this is *māyā*. Although it is external, it has the power to cover even the jīva, who consists of the marginal potency. Its covering lies on bodies from Brahmā down to the unmoving beings, now lighter, now heavier. *Pradhāna* lacks such qualities as spirituality and changelessness; one should understand that it is this inconceivable māyā that makes it material and changeable. The internal, marginal and external potencies are one in nature [with the Truth]. It is said here only that each of them resembles its image in one respect, not in all: they take the place of the disc, the rays and the reflection, but are not identical with them. Therefore the defects of these images do not apply here.”

This one Supreme Truth, by the power of a natural potency beyond human understanding, always abides in four ways: as the *svarūpa*, as the manifestations of the *svarūpa*, as the jīva and as *pradhāna*. So too the sun has four aspects: the radiance within the disc, the disc itself, the rays issuing from the disc, and their reflection. Inconceivability means that the Truth accomplishes the impossible. Potency, too, is of three kinds: internal, external and marginal. The internal *svarūpa-śakti* reveals the full form of the *svarūpa* and its manifestations — Vaikuṇṭha, Goloka and the rest. The marginal potency reveals the spiritual forms of the pure jīvas, which are like the rays. The external potency, māyā, reveals the external manifestation connected with the Truth — material *pradhāna*, like the play of colours in a reflection. These are the four ways. The jīva is a part of It and therefore the marginal potency, while *pradhāna* belongs to māyā; understanding this, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* counts three potencies. The potency that does the work of ignorance (*avidyā*) is called

māyā. This potency is external, and yet it is given the power to cover the jīva, who consists of the marginal potency. The jīvas covered by māyā abide, to a greater or lesser degree, in bodies from the unmoving beings up to Brahmā. *Pradhāna* lacks such qualities as spirituality and changelessness — it is material and changeable; one should know that this happens only by the will of the inconceivable māyā. The internal, marginal and external potencies are one in nature, and they are equal in being potencies. But they do not resemble each other in everything: it is said of them only that they take the place [of the disc, the rays and the reflection], not that they are those images. Therefore the defects proper to the marginal and external potencies have no place in the internal potency. Nor do the defects of the external potency have a place in the marginal, or those of the marginal in the external.

কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপের হয় ষড্বিধ বিলাস ।
প্রাভব-বৈভব-রূপে দ্বিবিধ প্রকাশ ॥ ৯৭ ॥

kṛṣṇera svarūpera haya ṣaḍ-vidha vilāsa
of Kṛṣṇa of the own form are sixfold pastime forms
prābhava-vaibhava-rūpe dvi-vidha prakāśa
prābhava vaibhava in the forms twofold manifestation

97 Kṛṣṇa's own form has six kinds of pastime forms (*vilāsa*): His manifestations are of two kinds, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*;

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Prābhava and *vaibhava* are those whose forms, full of being, consciousness and bliss, are equal to Hari's, but who are slightly below His supreme state. Their names depend on the measure of potency: where lordship (*prabhutā*) predominates, there is *prābhava*; where greatness (*vibhutā*) predominates, *vaibhava*. *Prābhava* is of two kinds. *Prābhavas* of the first kind remain in the world only briefly: for example, Mohinī, Haṁsa, Śukla and other short-lived avatāras connected with particular ages. The fame of *prābhavas* of the second kind does not spread very widely: for example, Dhanvantari, Ṛṣabha, Vyāsa, Dattātreya, Kapila and others. But Kūrma, Matsya, Nara-Nārāyaṇa, Varāha, Hayagrīva, Pṛśnigarbha, Baladeva and the avatāras of the fourteen *manvantaras* — Yajña, Vibhu, Satyasena, Hari, Vaikuṇṭha, Ajita, Vāmana, Sārvabhauma, Ṛṣabha, Viṣvaksena, Dharmasetu, Sudhāmā, Yogeśvara and Bṛhadbhānu — are *vaibhava-avatāras*.

অংশ-শক্ত্যাবেশরূপে দ্বিবিধাবতার ।
বাল্য-পৌগণ্ড-ধর্ম্ম দুই ত' প্রকার ॥ ৯৮ ॥

aṁśa-śaktyāveśa-rūpe dvi-vidhāvatāra
portion empowered in the forms twofold avatāras
bālya-paugaṇḍa-dharma dui ta' prakāra
of childhood of boyhood nature two indeed kinds

98 His avatāras are of two kinds, partial (*aṁśa*) and empowered (*śaktyāveśa*); and His pastimes are of two kinds, those of childhood (*bālya*) and of boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *aṁśāveśa-* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras* are explained elsewhere. They too are counted among the *prābhavas* and *vaibhavas*. The same holds for the *guṇa-avatāras*.

কিশোরস্বরূপ কৃষ্ণ স্বয়ং অবতারী ।
ক্রীড়া করে এই ছয়-রূপে বিশ্ব ভরি' ॥ ৯৯ ॥

kiśora-svarūpa kṛṣṇa svayaṁ avatārī
youthful in His own form Kṛṣṇa Himself the source of avatāras
krīḍā kare ei chaya-rūpe viśva bhari'
pastimes performs in these six forms the universe filling

99 Kṛṣṇa in His own form is youthful (*kiśora*): He Himself is the source of the avatāras. In these six forms He sports, filling the universe.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa is eternally youthful (*nitya-kiśora*), and He has two kinds of pastimes, in childhood (*bālya*) and in boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*). Therefore the source of the avatāras Himself is precisely Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form.

এই ছয়-রূপে হয় অনন্ত বিভেদ ।
অনন্তরূপে একরূপ, নাহি কিছু ভেদ ॥ ১০০ ॥

ei chaya-rūpe haya ananta vibheda
in these six forms there are unlimited varieties
ananta-rūpe eka-rūpa, nāhi kichu bheda
in unlimited forms one form, there is not any difference

100 Within these six forms there are unlimited varieties; yet in all those unlimited forms there is one form, and no difference at all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* displays six kinds of *vilāsa*: two kinds of manifestation, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*; two kinds of avatāra, *aṁśa* and *śaktyāveśa*; and two ages, *bālya* and *pauganḍa*. In these six kinds of *vilāsa* of His *svarūpa*, Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form performs pastimes throughout the universe. Thus these six forms divide without end. But even having become endless, Kṛṣṇa remains the one undivided Truth.

The cit-śakti and its manifestations —

চিচ্ছক্তি, স্বরূপশক্তি, অন্তরঙ্গা নাম ।
তাহার বৈভব অনন্ত বৈকুণ্ঠাদি ধাম ॥ ১০১ ॥

cic-chakti, svarūpa-śakti, antaraṅgā nāma
the spiritual potency, the personal potency, internal by name
tāhāra vaibhava ananta vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma
its opulence unlimited Vaikuṇṭhas and other abodes

101 The spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) is also called the personal potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the internal potency (*antaraṅgā*); her opulence is the unlimited abodes, such as the Vaikuṇṭhas.

The māyā-śakti and its manifestations —

মায়াশক্তি, বহিরঙ্গা, জগৎকারণ ।
তাহার বৈভব অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের গণ ॥ ১০২ ॥

māyā-śakti, bahiraṅgā, jagat-kāraṇa
the potency māyā, external, of the world the cause
tāhāra vaibhava ananta brahmāṇḍera gaṇa
its opulence unlimited of universes the multitudes

102 The potency māyā, the external potency, is the cause of the world: her opulence is the unlimited multitude of universes.

The jīva-śakti —

জীবশক্তি তটস্থাখ্য, নাহি যার অন্ত ।
মুখ্য তিন শক্তি, তার বিভেদ অনন্ত ॥ ১০৩ ॥

jīva-śakti taṭasthākhya, nāhi yāra anta
the potency of souls marginal called, there is not of which an end
mukhya tina śakti, tāra vibheda ananta
principal three potencies, their varieties unlimited

103 The potency of the souls, called marginal (*taṭasthā*), has no end. These are the three principal potencies, and their varieties are unlimited.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *cit-śakti*, or *svarūpa-śakti*, is also called the internal potency. From it come the endless manifestations of splendour in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes. From the marginal potency, the *jīva-śakti*, come the countless jīvas, conditioned and liberated. From the external potency, the *māyā-śakti*, comes the endless variety of material universes.

Anubhāṣya.
Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad, Chapter 6, mantra 8: "He has no work and no organs of action; no one is seen equal to Him or higher than Him. The Śrutis say that His supreme potency is manifold, and knowledge, strength and action belong to Him by nature."

Where the forms of the svarūpa and the potencies abide —

এই ত' স্বরূপগণ, আর তিন শক্তি ।
সবার আশ্রয় কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণে সবার স্থিতি ॥ ১০৪ ॥

ei ta' svarūpa-gaṇa, āra tina śakti
these indeed the personal forms, and three potencies
sabāra āśraya kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇe sabāra sthiti
of all the shelter Kṛṣṇa, in Kṛṣṇa of all the abiding

104 Such are His personal forms and His three potencies. Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of them all; in Kṛṣṇa they all abide.

যদ্যপি ব্রহ্মাণ্ডগণের পুরুষ আশ্রয় ।
সেহ পুরুষাদি সবার কৃষ্ণ মূলাশ্রয় ॥ ১০৫ ॥

yadyapi brahmāṇḍa-gaṇera puruṣa āśraya
although of the universes the Puruṣa the shelter
seha puruṣādi sabāra kṛṣṇa mūlāśraya
of those Puruṣas and others of all Kṛṣṇa the original shelter

105 Although the Puruṣa is the shelter of the universes, Kṛṣṇa is the original shelter of all — of the Puruṣas and the rest.

Who Kṛṣṇa is —

স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্বাশ্রয় ।
পরম ঈশ্বর কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে কয় ॥ ১০৬ ॥

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa sarvāśraya
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa the shelter of all
parama īśvara kṛṣṇa sarva-śāstre kaya
the supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa in all scriptures is said

106 Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of all. All the scriptures declare Kṛṣṇa to be the Supreme Lord.

(Brahma-saṁhitā 5.1)

ঈশ্বরঃ পরমঃ কৃষ্ণঃ সচ্চিদানন্দবিগ্রহঃ ।
অনাদিরাদির্গোবিন্দঃ সর্ব্বকারণকারণম্ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

īśvaraḥ paramaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ
the Lord Supreme Kṛṣṇa
sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ
of being knowledge bliss whose form
anādir ādir govindaḥ
without beginning the beginning Govinda
sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam
of all causes the cause

107 "Kṛṣṇa, Govinda, is the Supreme Lord; His form is eternal being, knowledge and bliss. He has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all, the cause of all causes." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Supreme Lord is Kṛṣṇa, the form of being, consciousness and bliss. He Himself has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all and the cause of all causes.

Anubhāṣya.
kṛṣṇaḥ (Kṛṣṇa, Vrajendranandana) **paramaḥ īśvaraḥ** (the Supreme Lord. He is the Master of all: of Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; of the *puruṣa-avatāras*, the Paramātmās who lie in the three oceans — Kāraṇa, Garbha and Kṣīrārṇava; of the *naimittika-avatāras* — Matsya, Kūrma, Varāha, Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and others; of the *guṇa-avatāras* — Brahmā, Śiva and others; of the impersonal Brahman; and of the *vibhūti-avatāras* — Mahendra and the rest) **sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ** (the form of being, consciousness and bliss, endowed with three potencies: *sandhinī*, *saṁvit* and *hlādinī*) **anādiḥ** (without beginning; of Him it is said, "I alone was in the beginning.") **ādiḥ** (the original form of all) **sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam** (the cause, the root, of all causes) **govindaḥ** (Govinda).

এ সব সিদ্ধান্ত তুমি জান ভালমতে ।
তবু পূর্ব্বপক্ষ কর আমা চালাইতে ॥ ১০৮ ॥

e saba siddhānta tumi jāna bhāla-mate
these all conclusions you know well
tabu pūrva-pakṣa kara āmā cālāite
yet objections you make me to unsettle

108 You know all these conclusions well, and yet you raise objections, only to unsettle me.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Calāite means "to unsettle me needlessly."

Śrī Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa, Himself the source of the avatāras —

সেই কৃষ্ণ অবতারী ব্রজেন্দ্রকুমার ।
আপনে চৈতন্যরূপে কৈল অবতার ॥ ১০৯ ॥

sei kṛṣṇa avatārī vrajendra-kumāra
that Kṛṣṇa the source of avatāras of the king of Vraja the son
āpane caitanya-rūpe kaila avatāra
Himself in the form of Caitanya made descent

109 That Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, the son of the king of Vraja, has Himself descended in the form of Caitanya.

In Śrī Caitanya, the source of the avatāras, all the avatāras are contained —

অতএব চৈতন্য-গোসাঞি পরতত্ত্ব-সীমা ।
তাঁরে ক্ষীরোদশায়ী কহি, কি তাঁর মহিমা ॥ ১১০ ॥

ataeva caitanya-gosāñi paratattva-sīmā
therefore Caitanya Gosāñi of the Supreme Truth the limit
tāṁre kṣīroda-śāyī kahi, ki tāṁra mahimā
Him Kṣīrodaśāyī calling, what His glory

110 Therefore Caitanya Gosāñi is the furthest limit of the Supreme Truth. To call Him Kṣīrodaśāyī — what glory is that to Him?

Therefore it is no error to call Him by any name of Viṣṇu —

সেই ত' ভক্তের বাক্য নহে ব্যভিচারী ।
সকল সম্ভবে তাঁতে, যাতে অবতারী ॥ ১১১ ॥

sei ta' bhaktera vākya nahe vyabhicārī
that indeed of the devotee the word is not erroneous
sakala sambhave tāṁte, yāte avatārī
all is possible in Him, since the source of avatāras

111 Yet such words of a devotee are not wrong: everything is possible in Him, for He is the source of the avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya, Chapter 6, 95: "I was lying in the Ocean of Milk — and Nāḍā's roar broke My sleep."[18]

অবতারীর দেহে সব অবতারের স্থিতি ।
কেহো কোনমতে কহে, যেমন যার মতি ॥ ১১২ ॥

avatārīra dehe saba avatārera sthiti
of the source of avatāras in the body of all avatāras the presence
keho kona-mate kahe, yemana yāra mati
someone in some way speaks, according as whose understanding

112 All the avatāras are present in the body of their source; so each speaks of Him in his own way, according to his understanding.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In some books Śrī Caitanya is called Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha. This does not describe His greatness fully, yet the words of those devotees are not false either. For Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who is non-different from Kṛṣṇa, is Himself the source of the avatāras, and so all the avatāras abide in Him.

কৃষ্ণকে কহয়ে কেহ — নরনারায়ণ ।
কেহো কহে, কৃষ্ণ হয় সাক্ষাৎ বামন ॥ ১১৩ ॥

kṛṣṇake kahaye keha — nara-nārāyaṇa
Kṛṣṇa calls someone — Nara-Nārāyaṇa
keho kahe, kṛṣṇa haya sākṣāt vāmana
someone says, Kṛṣṇa is directly Vāmana

113 Some call Kṛṣṇa Nara-Nārāyaṇa; others say that Kṛṣṇa is Vāmana Himself.

কেহো কহে, কৃষ্ণ ক্ষীরোদশায়ী অবতার ।
অসম্ভব নহে, সত্য বচন সবার ॥ ১১৪ ॥

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa kṣīroda-śāyī avatāra
someone says, Kṛṣṇa of Kṣīrodaśāyī an avatāra
asambhava nahe, satya vacana sabāra
impossible it is not, true the words of all

114 Some say that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. Nothing of this is impossible; the words of all of them are true.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where Kṛṣṇa is described as the source of the avatāras, it is said: "Therefore in the Purāṇas and other scriptures the sages, following particular events, name Kṛṣṇa differently: some call Him Narasakha, the Friend of Nara; others, the younger brother of Mahendra; still others, the One who lies in the Ocean of Milk; some, the Thousand-headed One; and some, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha."

কেহো কহে, পরব্যোমে নারায়ণ-হরি ।
সকল সম্ভবে কৃষ্ণে, যাতে অবতারী ॥ ১১৫ ॥

keho kahe, para-vyome nārāyaṇa-hari
someone says, in the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa Hari
sakala sambhave kṛṣṇe, yāte avatārī
all is possible in Kṛṣṇa, since the source of avatāras

115 Some call Him Nārāyaṇa, Hari of the spiritual sky. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa, for He is the source of the avatāras.

All devotees, on the path of vaidhī and on the path of rāgānugā alike,

absolutely need to know the conclusions of devotion —

সব শ্রোতাগণের করি চরণ বন্দন ।
এ সব সিদ্ধান্ত শুন, করি' এক মন ॥ ১১৬ ॥

saba śrotā-gaṇera kari caraṇa vandana
of all the listeners I make to the feet obeisance
e saba siddhānta śuna, kari' eka mana
these all conclusions hear, making one-pointed the mind

116 I bow down at the feet of all my listeners: hear all these conclusions with undivided attention.

সিদ্ধান্ত বলিয়া চিত্তে না কর অলস ।
ইহা হৈতে কৃষ্ণে লাগে সুদৃঢ় মানস ॥ ১১৭ ॥

siddhānta baliyā citte nā kara alasa
conclusions thinking them in the mind not be idle
ihā haite kṛṣṇe lāge sudṛḍha mānasa
from this to Kṛṣṇa becomes attached firmly the mind

117 Do not be indifferent to them, thinking them mere doctrine; from them the mind becomes firmly attached to Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Some who thirst for devotion do not count these conclusions (*siddhāntas*) as part of devotion and are too lazy to study them. But this does not lead to good. For when one has understood one's relationship with Kṛṣṇa (*sambandha-jñāna*), the mind becomes firmly attached to His lotus feet. Therefore such true conclusions are the root of pure devotion.

Thus ends the second chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Many see the example of devotees in whom taste (*ruci*) has awakened and think it is not so necessary to study the conclusions (*siddhānta*). Out of such laziness many grow poor in worship (*bhajana*) and turn away from Kṛṣṇa. They take for devotion material feelings hostile to devotion, and fall under the sway of *anarthas*. The path led by reasoning suits those in whom taste has not yet awakened. Yet those in

whom taste has awakened but is still weak have special need of hearing, a part of devotion (*śravaṇāṅga*). Without hearing the conclusions about Kṛṣṇa, taste does not grow. Among the nine kinds of devotion, hearing is prescribed at the very beginning, before glorification. The creeper of devotion grows only when it is watered with hearing and glorification. Even Brahmā, when he praised Kṛṣṇa and described the devotees who had given up the effort for knowledge, said: "…the news of You, resounding from the mouths of the sādhus and reaching the ear." The *Bhāgavatam* grants the pure knowledge of the *paramahaṁsas*. Only one who reads and hears it while reflecting on it attains the level of a *mahā-bhāgavata*. In Śrī Mahāprabhu's teachings to Sanātana we hear: "One who is expert in scripture and reasoning and has firm faith is a devotee of the highest level; he delivers the world." And Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmīpāda said that one must give up laziness: "Devotion is perfected by six qualities: enthusiasm, conviction, patience, carrying out the prescribed duties, giving up [bad] company, and following the conduct of the sādhus."[19]

Those who claim to be devotees without knowing the conclusions often, out of foolishness, artificially practice the *sāttvika-vikāras* (spiritual transformations), and so lower the standing of a Vaiṣṇava in people's eyes. Condemning this bad habit, the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* gives the verse *tad aśma-sāram.…*[20] In his commentary on it Śrīpāda Cakravartī Ṭhākura says: "If there are tears and thrilling outside but the heart is not transformed, that heart is made of stone. This censure is aimed at devotees of the lowest level (*kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs*): even when they have tears, thrilling and the like, their hearts are of stone." When the conclusions are not respected, artificial devotion appears; Śrī Rūpa Prabhu painted its picture like this: "In those whose hearts are slippery by nature, and in those who practice it, tears, thrilling and the like sometimes appear even without a semblance of *sattva*." Here too is a vivid example of how the crowd of false devotees, lacking the conclusions, take transformations of māyā for transcendental ones.

Many condemn even reading the works on *siddhānta* written by the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas — Śrī Rāmānuja, Madhvācārya, Nimbārka, Viṣṇusvāmī and others — just as they condemn studying the books of the Advaitavādīs, who are hostile to devotion. Yet for the good of the Vaiṣṇavas Śrī Jīva quoted precisely their excellent conclusions in the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*. The impersonalists (*nirviśeṣa-vādīs*) mistakenly take the parts of devotion for parts of karma. So too jīvas who are Vaiṣṇavas in name only, not knowing the conclusions, imagine that conclusions favourable to devotion are hostile to it — and fall away from devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

Love for worship (bhajana) is born of the conclusions of devotion —

চৈতন্য-মহিমা জানি এ সব সিদ্ধান্তে ।
চিত্ত দৃঢ় হঞা লাগে মহিমা-জ্ঞান হৈতে ॥ ১১৮ ॥

caitanya-mahimā jāni e saba siddhānte
Caitanya's greatness I know by these all conclusions
citta dṛḍha hañā lāge mahimā-jñāna haite
the mind firm becoming is attached of greatness knowledge from

118 Through all these conclusions I come to know the greatness of Caitanya; and from knowing His greatness the mind becomes firm and attached to Him.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Pañcarātra*: "Firm love (*sneha*), surpassing all and joined with knowledge of [the Lord's] greatness, is called devotion; by it [one attains] *sārṣṭi* and the rest, and by nothing else." "In those who follow the path of rules it is joined with knowledge of His greatness; but in those who have taken shelter of *rāgānugā* it is usually pure (*kevala*)."

The author describes the truth about Kṛṣṇa only to establish faith in Caitanya —

চৈতন্যপ্রভুর মহিমা কহিবার তরে ।
কৃষ্ণের মহিমা কহি করিয়া বিস্তারে ॥ ১১৯ ॥

caitanya-prabhura mahimā kahibāra tare
Caitanya the Lord's greatness to tell for the sake of
kṛṣṇera mahimā kahi kariyā vistāre
Kṛṣṇa's greatness I tell making in detail

119 To tell the greatness of Caitanya Prabhu, I have described the greatness of Kṛṣṇa in detail.

He who is Kṛṣṇa is Caitanya —

চৈতন্য-গোসাঞির এই তত্ত্ব-নিরূপণ ।
স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ১২০ ॥

caitanya-gosāñira ei tattva-nirūpaṇa
Caitanya Gosāñi's this of the truth determination
svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa vrajendra-nandana
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa of the king of Vraja the son

120 This is the determination of the truth of Caitanya Gosāñi: He is Bhagavān Himself, Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the second chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১২১ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

121 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Indicating the Object (*vastu-nirdeśa*) is one of the three kinds of auspicious invocation (Ādi 1.22). ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.3. ↩
3. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «চারি হাত» (another spelling: «হাথ»). ↩
4. This is the first reason why Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa: *nāra* — all souls, *ayana* — their shelter (2.38). ↩
5. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তেঁহ তোমার প্রকাশ» — "He is Your manifestation". ↩

6. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «তেঁহ কৃষ্ণের প্রকাশ» (another reading: «তেঁহো কৃষ্ণের বিলাস»). In meaning this manifestation is a *vilāsa*: on 2.57 the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* calls Nārāyaṇa "a secondary manifestation in the form of *vilāsa*". ↩
7. The same verse as 2.11 (so the *Anubhāṣya* also notes). ↩
8. The reference is as in the edition: "a rule of rhetoric, *Ekādaśī-tattva*, 13". ↩
9. This refers to verse 2.67 (*ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ*). ↩
10. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: *ūti* — karmic desires; *manvantara* — the righteous path given by Manu; *īśānukathā* — the accounts of Hari's avatāras; *nirodha* — the Lord with His potencies lying down in sleep; *mukti* — abiding in one's pure nature; *āśraya* — the Supreme Brahman, the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution. ↩
11. The verse translation reads differently: it takes *ātma-kalpita* as "created by Himself" (as the *Anubhāṣya* also glosses it), whereas here it is read as "made one's own," that is, those who know themselves as the Lord's servants. ↩
12. The edition reads *atan-māyā-rahita* (literally "free from māyā, [which is] not-That"); taken here as "untouched by māyā." ↩
13. The edition reads *māyā vā advaya-jñāna-dvārā* ("by māyā, or nondual knowledge"); the sense probably requires *dvaya-jñāna*, dual knowledge (compare *dvaita-jñāna* in the same sentence); translated by the sense. ↩
14. *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.1–3. ↩
15. Sources not named in the edition: *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.7 and 3.12; *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.3; *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.33–34 and 7.9.38. ↩
16. *Māyāyām*, literally "in Māyā"; usually understood as Māyāpura. ↩
17. *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.2.13; *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.13. ↩
18. Nāḍā is a nickname of Advaita Ācārya. ↩
19. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.14.3; *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 22.65; *Upadeśāmṛta* 3. ↩
20. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.3.24. ↩